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Unpopular opinion.
SIP, an useful discipline, is not the autopilot route to wealth
BIG STORY P2



Investors' black hole.
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Nifty 50's long-term historical performance reassures FPIs 'don't write me off just yet'

NOT DOWN & OUT. While it is wise to acknowledge current challenges, it is important to not throw out the baby with the bathwater

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

When times are tough, it gets even tougher when compared with better-performing players. Indian markets are exactly in that spot today, as demanding valuations, impact on earnings growth from geopolitical turmoil, lack of good AI plays, and currency depreciation push them closer to the bottom of the pile in terms of FPI preference.

In dollar-denominated returns, South Korea's Kospi is up a staggering 171 per cent in the last one year, Taiwan's benchmark index TWSE is up 81 per cent, Brazil's Ibovespa is up 45 per cent and the S&P 500 is up 27 per cent. Against this backdrop, the Nifty 50's negative 15.3 per cent dollar-denominated returns over the past year make it appear like a clear under-performer.

But what if investors move beyond the T20 timeframe and shift to a Test match ho-

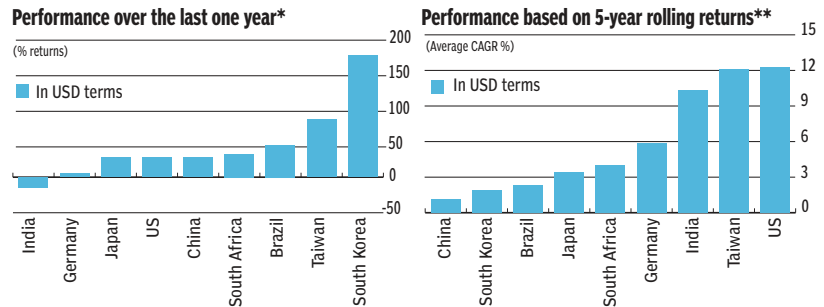
izon? The perspectives change a lot.

A *bl.portfolio* analysis of five-year dollar-denominated returns across major global indices indicates that while current challenges are real — and there could be more pain ahead — the Nifty 50's long-term consistency suggests that, after a valuation reset and a turn in the cycle, the timing of which remains uncertain, better days could return. That is why it is important not to throw the baby out with the bathwater.

CONSISTENCY INTACT When measured through five-year rolling returns over the past decade, India remains among the stronger-performing markets globally.

The Nifty 50 has delivered 10.3 per cent annualised returns (average) in dollar terms positioning it favourably relative to most peers. Only the S&P 500 (12.3 per cent) and Taiwan (12.1 per cent) outperform India in dollar terms, while key markets such as China (1.1 per

Dollar blues, but compounding intact



India fares well in return stability and lower downside risk										Distribution of five-year rolling returns in USD terms (%)	
Return range	India	US	China	Japan	South Africa	Brazil	Taiwan	South Korea	Germany		
Negative returns	0	0	29	20	25	38	0	36	13		
0% to 5%	3	0	70	43	42	33	3	42	23		
5% to 10%	43	25	1	38	13	18	25	18	42		
10% to 20%	53	75	0	0	20	10	72	4	21		
Above 20%	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0		

cent), Japan (3.4 per cent) and Brazil (2.3 per cent) lag significantly despite having outperformed India over the past year.

The distribution analysis of five-year rolling returns in dollar terms, which captures both return potential and downside risk, further high-

lights India's relative strength.

NO NEGATIVE RETURN The data reveal that India has recorded no negative five-year rolling returns, placing it in a select group alongside the S&P 500 and Taiwan's TWSE. A majority of obser-

vations fall within the 10-20 per cent annualised return band (53 per cent), with a further 43 per cent in the 5-10 per cent range. This points to a high degree of return stability and predictability, with limited exposure to extreme outcomes on either the upside or downside. In

contrast, several emerging markets exhibit significantly less favourable return distributions. Brazil, for instance, recorded negative returns in 38 per cent of the observations, while South Korea and China also displayed high frequencies of suboptimal outcomes.

Even developed markets such as Germany and Japan showed a more dispersed return profile, particularly on the lower side of the return spectrum.

These comparisons highlight a key attribute of Indian equities: consistent long-term compounding rather than sporadic bursts of high performance.

VOLATILITY ISSUE

Further, annualised standard deviation data highlights the volatility profile of major global markets. India's volatility, at 19.1 per cent, was higher than that of the US and Japan, but lower than most emerging markets such as South Korea, Brazil and Taiwan.

The takeaway is straightforward: while near-term volatility may persist amid evolving global macroeconomic conditions, the longer-term data reinforces India's position as a relatively stable and consistent wealth creator.

This is perhaps something FPIs already understand, having entered, exited and re-entered India multiple times over the years. What domestic investors need to recognise is that while FII re-entry may be inevitable, the timing may not align with market expectations. Several prominent Indian fund managers have already made predictions on this front that have failed badly.

A number of other factors will need to fall into place before sustained foreign inflows return. While it is prudent to acknowledge current challenges and position investments accordingly, it would be equally unwise to write off the India story based solely on one-year performance headlines.

Goldman Sachs, Societe Generale, others buy 1.3% stake in Paytm parent for ₹963 cr

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Global financial institutions, including Goldman Sachs, Societe Generale, and Citigroup Global Markets, have collectively acquired a 1.34 per cent stake in One97 Communications, the parent company of Paytm, from SAIF Partners and Elevation Capital for ₹963 crore through open market transactions.

Other foreign investors participating in the transaction included Ghisallo Capital Management, BNP Paribas, Copthall Mauritius Investment, and Hong Kong-based Viridian Asset Management.

Among domestic institutional investors, Sundaram Mutual Fund (MF), Nippon India MF, Edelweiss Mutual Fund and India Acorn ICAV also bought shares of the fintech firm, as per the block deal data executed on the BSE on Friday.

These entities collectively purchased a total of 85.98 lakh shares on the exchange, representing a 1.34 per cent stake in Noida-based One97 Communications.

The shares were bought at an average price of ₹1,120.65 a piece, taking the transaction value to ₹963.60 crore.

Meanwhile, Hong Kong-based private equity firm SAIF Partners, through its affiliates — SAIF III Mauritius Company Ltd and SAIF Partners India IV Ltd — offloaded a combined 80.08 lakh shares of Paytm.

Further, Gurugram-based venture capital firm Elevation Capital also disposed of 5.89 lakh shares in the fintech company. The shares were offloaded at the same price, as per the data on the BSE.

Following the transaction, SAIF Partners' holding in One 97 Communications declined to 12.18 per cent from 13.43 per cent.

In November 2025, PE firm SAIF Partners divested a 1.86 per cent stake in Paytm for ₹1,556 crore.



'ENERGETIC' TALKS. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio met Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday to discuss trade and energy ties during a visit aimed at strengthening relations strained by Washington's tariff measures and its engagement with India's regional rivals, Pakistan and China ANI

Rubio, Modi discuss bilateral trade, energy security, West Asia crisis

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio held wide ranging discussions on strengthening cooperation in sectors such as trade, energy security and critical technologies and also discussed the West Asia situation on Saturday, the government said.

Rubio, who is on a four-day visit to India amid the West Asia crisis that is shaking up the global economy, arrived in Kolkata on Saturday morning. He visited Mother Teresa's Missionaries of Charity before flying to Delhi.

"Happy to receive the US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. We discussed sustained progress in the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership and issues related to regional and global peace and security," Modi posted on social media platform 'X' following his meeting.

In his statement at the US Embassy in New Delhi, Rubio said India remained a cornerstone of the US ap-

proach to the Indo-Pacific region and he was in India to build upon the partnership between the two countries, which was an incredibly important one.

"We think in the months ahead, we're going to have even more exciting and new announcements to make about the development and the strengthening of the relationship between the two countries," he added.

He also announced a new "America First" visa schedule that would prioritise business professionals "that strengthen these ties."

STRENGTHEN TIES

Rubio said US President Donald Trump had a personal relationship with Modi and the two leaders were focussed on not just the short term but also the long term.

"In the past year, the relationship has deepened," he said. US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor joined Rubio in his meeting with Modi.

"We had a productive discussion on ways to deepen US-India cooperation across security, trade, and critical technologies — areas that strengthen both our nations and advance a free and open

Indo-Pacific. India is a vital partner to the United States!" Gor stated in his post on 'X'.

The Secretary will attend the Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting, hosted by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, on Monday. Foreign Ministers of Japan and Australia have also confirmed their attendance.

Jaishankar will hold bilateral talks with Rubio on Sunday with the focus expected to be on energy security, trade and tariffs including the proposed bilateral trade agreement, and defence cooperation.

Prior to his travel, Rubio had said that the US was prepared to increase energy exports to India.

"Well, we want to sell them (India) as much energy as they'll buy...we're at historic levels of US production, and US export...We want them to be a bigger part of their portfolio," he said addressing reporters.

Rubio is also likely to push for progress in the India-US bilateral trade agreement (BTA) talks that will give greater market access in India to US exporters of industrial and agricultural goods.

In a third price hike in 10 days, petrol costlier by 87 paise/litre, diesel by 91 paise/litre, CNG by ₹1/kg

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

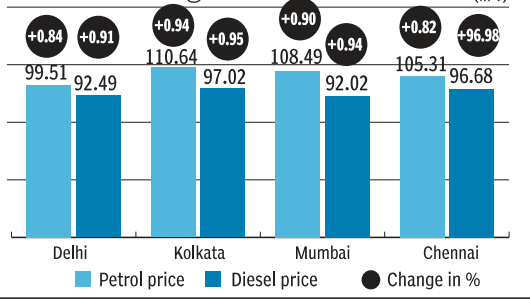
State-owned oil marketing companies (OMCs) on Saturday yet again raised petrol and diesel prices by 87 paise and 91 paise per litre, respectively. With this third hike in 10 days, retail fuel prices have risen by nearly ₹5 a litre.

Compressed natural gas (CNG) prices were increased by ₹1 per kg, the third upward revision taking the cumulative hike to ₹4.

CRUDE SURGE

Indian Oil Corporation said petrol and diesel sales rose 14 per cent and 18 per cent, respectively, during the first 22 days of May, while assuring consumers that there was no shortage of fuel supplies.

Fuel surcharge



This is the third increase in fuel prices since May 15, when State-owned OMCs began passing on the nearly 50 per cent surge in crude oil prices triggered by the West Asia conflict.

India imports nearly 85 per cent of its crude oil requirements, making domestic fuel prices highly sensitive to global oil market movements. The latest in-

crease is expected to add to cost pressures for commuters, transporters and businesses across sectors.

Petrol and diesel prices are now at their highest levels since May 2022.

CNG PRICES UP AGAIN

In a separate statement, Indraprastha Gas Limited said the retail selling price of CNG had been raised by ₹1

per kg with effect from 6 am on May 23 across all its geographical areas.

The company said the revision was aimed at "marginally offsetting" higher input gas costs and the sharp appreciation in the US dollar.

IOC REACTION

Indian Oil said there was no overall shortage of petrol and diesel in the country, though some fuel stations could face temporary localised supply issues.

It attributed higher fuel demand at certain locations to seasonal diesel consumption during the harvesting season, temporary migration of customers from private fuel outlets charging relatively higher prices, and increased institutional and commercial demand shifting to PSU retail outlets.

Also read p12

Shopian comes out in strength against drugs

Huge turnout at LG-led rally underscores the district's changing social landscape

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

On a balmy Saturday morning marked by intermittent sunshine and light showers, Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha walked through the streets of Shopian, around 50 km south of Srinagar, as thousands joined him on a *padayatra* under a 100-day anti-drug campaign.

Until a few years ago, such a spectacle would have been unimaginable. Once seen as a militancy stronghold in south Kashmir, Shopian was a district where political leaders struggled to hold public meetings and election rallies meant heavy security and thin crowds. Saturday's turnout reflected the scale of change the district has undergone.

Officials estimated that



SYMBOL OF CHANGE. Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha takes part in a *padayatra* on Saturday PTI

45,000-50,000 people participated in the rally, pledging support for a drug-free society. "The turnout was unprecedented. I haven't seen such a large gathering here in years," said 60-year-old Mohammad Ashraf, who joined the march along the rain-soaked streets.

The administration launched the *Nasha Mukht Jammu & Kashmir* campaign on April 1 to dismantle the drug economy,

combat narco-terrorism and curb substance abuse through enforcement, rehabilitation and public outreach. Official data showed agencies seized 19,345 kg of drugs in 2022, 10,307 kg in 2023, 5,219 kg in 2024 and 4,019 kg till November 2025.

Since April 11 this year, authorities have arrested 897 smugglers and peddlers, recommended cancellation of 18 passports,

revoked 382 driving licences and cancelled registrations of 386 vehicles. Forty-nine immovable properties were seized and 45 demolished during the crackdown.

Officials estimate nearly one million people in Jammu and Kashmir — about 8 per cent of the population — use drugs such as cannabis, opioids and sedatives.

"We will work with full commitment to uproot narco-terrorism and dismantle its ecosystem," Sinha told the gathering, describing narco-terrorism as "a deliberate attack on the soul of Jammu and Kashmir". He said drug proceeds were being used by militant groups to procure weapons, while the spread of narcotics was eroding the social fabric and pushing youth away from progress.

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

First brought in as a concept more than three decades ago, SIP, or systematic investment plan, today has virtually become the comfort food Indian investors binge monthly. For full FY26 (April 2025 to March 2026), SIP contributions (gross) stood at nearly ₹3.5 lakh crore — over eight times the level seen a decade ago. That is a tsunami of mostly retail investor money. None of this makes the SIP faith irrational. Discipline over two decades has indeed produced many rags-to-riches stories. But the journey and the outcome has not been equally rewarding for everyone. That unevenness is not merely theoretical. Over one-third of the two-year SIPs in mutual fund schemes across market-cap categories are currently showing losses. SIP discipline remains useful, but it is not a 100 per cent autopilot route to wealth. Returns depend not only on staying invested, but also on where one invests, when the SIP begins and how markets behave along the way.

In this article, we focus on the other side of the SIP story for equity funds. Why? Because a proactive investor in today's dynamic world can no longer afford to outsource their financial awareness to a system incentivised by assets rather than absolute outcomes. Distributors earn trail commissions to keep your capital parked, while fund managers are strictly bound by mandates to deploy your monthly SIP inflows, even when they may know the broader market is severely overvalued.

A “fill it, shut it, forget it” approach is a dangerous luxury in a hyper-evolving world where rapid technological shifts, such as AI, are aggressively rewriting business models and market cycles.

UNDERSTANDING SIPs

In a mutual fund SIP, the investor is not buying the units at the same price every month. She is buying units at different prices (NAV's), as the price of the underlying securities change. The return (XIRR) is, therefore, not merely a function of where the buying starts and ends. It is a function of every purchase price in between. This is why two SIPs with similar point-to-point returns can produce different return (XIRRs).

At the end of the day, SIP is just a cash-flow method. A monthly SIP can produce very different results depending on when the market falls, and when it rises. For instance, a strong multi-year rally in the Sensex during a five-year SIP can result in compounding at nearly 19.75 per cent XIRR, as in the 2016-21 cycle.

By contrast, high starting valuations followed by a market correction just as the five-year SIP matured deflated returns to a modest 6 per cent XIRR, as seen in 2021-26 period ended May 20. And if a severe crash hits right at the end, it can temporarily leave a negative -2.6 per cent XIRR for a five-year Sensex SIP, as in 2015-20 period. In other words, the same disciplined habit — same monthly “debts,” same cash invested can look like a windfall in one cycle, mediocre in another and disappointing in a third. The difference isn't the investor; it's the path the market took.

MARKET DECIDES SIP PATH

To show how market-swings shape SIP outcomes, we modelled a ₹10,000 monthly investment in the Sensex over five years. We illustrate four hypothetical contrasting market paths: A sharp early dip followed by a recovery, a steady growth trajectory, a flat market with late gains and a strong early rally (see Table 1).

As you would notice, each path results in drastically-different final portfolio values and annualised returns (XIRR), ranging from 2.8 per cent to 10.9 per cent. This is despite identical cash flows and the exact same starting and ending index levels.

To map these market levels to a realistic mutual fund structure, the index was scaled down to represent a base Unit NAV (for example, 75,318 translates to a starting NAV of ₹75.32).

Using AI modelling, we selected four illustrative market paths from countless possibilities, each reaching the same endpoint i.e. 50 per cent absolute gain from current levels.

Crisis: An early, severe drop resulting in a 27.0 per cent maximum drawdown, followed by extended stagnation and a late recovery.

Steady upside: A smooth, linear rise interrupted only by minor 4.5 per cent corrections.

Flattish: Minimal overall growth for years, featuring an 8.0 per cent mid-cycle slump, before a sudden jump at the very end of the tenure.

Strong rally: Rapid, front-loaded growth causing an immediate NAV spike, followed by a prolonged plateau and a mild 2.5 per cent correction.

SIP RETURN DISTRIBUTION

The aforementioned theoretical scen-

The other side of SIP

UNPOPULAR OPINION. Over one-third of the two-year SIPs across market-cap categories are showing losses. While SIP discipline remains useful, it is not the autopilot route to wealth. Returns depend on staying invested, where one invests, when the SIP begins & how markets behave



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Table 1

Projected 5-year SIP returns across 4 hypothetical scenarios
Investor putting ₹10,000 monthly SIP

Market scenario	SIP invested value (₹ lakh)	Final SIP portfolio value (₹ lakh)	Absolute SIP gain (₹ lakh)	5Y SIP XIRR (%)	Avg. cost per unit (₹)	Total units purchased	Max monthly drawdown (%)
Crisis (drop, stagnation, recovery)	6	7.9	1.9	10.9	85.8	6,990	27.0
Steady upside (linear growth)	6	7.5	1.5	8.6	90.9	6,601	4.5
Flattish (stagnant then jump)	6	7.0	1.0	6.1	96.8	6,196	8.0
Strong rally (front-loaded gain)	6	6.4	0.4	2.8	105.2	5,702	2.5

Note: Starting Sensex value (75,318) and Ending Sensex value (112,977) are same for all scenarios, implying a 50% absolute gain

Table 2

SIP return probability curve

Index & SIP horizon	Current XIRR (%)	Best XIRR (%)	Worst XIRR (%)	Less than 8%	8 to 10%	10 to 15%	Over 15%
				% of times return has occurred			
BSE Sensex							
5-year SIP	6	20	-4	22	17	42	19
7-year SIP	9	17	0	15	14	61	10
10-year SIP	10	15	3	6	19	75	0
BSE Midcap							
5-year SIP	25	33	-7	16	8	22	54
7-year SIP	22	25	-3	9	7	27	57
10-year SIP	20	21	4	3	6	34	57
BSE Smallcap							
5-year SIP	15	39	-9	32	3	10	55
7-year SIP	21	30	-7	18	5	28	49
10-year SIP	18	23	0	11	10	24	55
BSE 500							
5-year SIP	10	24	-7	23	12	36	29
7-year SIP	13	20	-1	15	7	55	23
10-year SIP	13	17	2	4	11	72	13
BSE IT (Sector)							
5-year SIP	-7	39	-7	16	7	28	49
7-year SIP	2	29	2	10	9	25	56
10-year SIP	8	24	7	2	4	50	44
BSE PSU (Theme)							
5-year SIP	23	45	-18	64	9	5	22
7-year SIP	24	30	-15	74	3	4	19
10-year SIP	18	21	-11	71	4	3	22

Based on rolling monthly SIP XIRRs in price indices over 20 years ended May 2026. Current XIRR is for the period ending May 2026. Expenses, taxes and tracking difference are excluded. Figures are rounded; past returns may not recur

arios prove that the market's path dictates your return. But what paths have Indian equities historically taken? To move from theory to empirical evidence, we ran rolling historical SIP returns across different market caps and themes over the last 20 years ended May 20, 2026.

We tested five-year, seven-year and 10-year SIP horizons (see Table 2). The results show a massive dispersion in outcomes.

The width of the SIP probability curve tells the real story.

* Time heals broad markets, but kills the windfall: The data validates the core tenet of long-term investing, provided you stick to broad indices. Notice how extending a Sensex SIP from five to 10 years acts as a powerful volatility shock-absorber. The 'less than 8 per cent XIRR' possibility shrinks dramatically from 22 per cent down to just 6 per cent. However, time also actively crushes upside variance. Over a rolling 10-year period, the historical probability of earning a massive Sensex windfall (>15 per cent) collapsed to zero.

* The fat tails of small-caps: Stepping outside the large-cap safety net exposes investors to a much-wider dispersion of destinies. A five-year small-cap SIP is the

ultimate coin toss. Historically, there was a 55 per cent chance of a phenomenal windfall, paired directly with a 32 per cent chance of landing in the 'less than 8 per cent' zone. More importantly, time does not heal small-caps as perfectly as large caps. Even after 10 years of disciplined investing, historical small-cap SIPs still faced a 11 per cent risk of sub-8 per cent returns, with the absolute worst-case scenario remaining in break-even territory (0 per cent).

* The thematic trap: Perhaps the most crucial takeaway lies in the thematic divergence. The standard industry advice is to “give it more time” when an equity SIP is underperforming. For highly-cyclical themes, this advice can be fatal. Look at the BSE PSU matrix. Over a five-year horizon, 64 per cent of SIPs landed in the sub-8 per cent XIRR zone. When investors extended their horizon to 10 years, hoping time would bail them out, the sub-8 per cent return actually expanded to 71 per cent. After 120 months of averaging down, the absolute worst-case scenario remained negative (-11 per cent XIRR).

Our probability matrix shows that while a decade of patience might save a Sensex investor, it can actively destroy capital in cyclical or thematic funds. This

WISE WORDS.



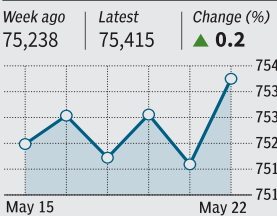
Risk control to me is how bad is it if you are wrong or how bad is it if the market doesn't recognize you are right for a long time.

CLIFF ASNESS

Founder AQR Capital Management

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY

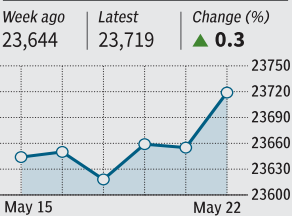


Table 3

Guide on how to shift SIP gains

Core broad markets

Trigger: Approaching 18% to 20% XIRR (over 3-5 years)

What to do: Rebalance. Returns at these levels have historically warranted a review of allocation and expectations. Skim the excess profits off the top and move them into safer asset classes (debt/fixed income) to restore your original asset allocation

Mid & Small Caps

Trigger: Crossing 20%+ XIRR (over 3-5 years)

What to do: Harvest and rotate. These are not “buy and hold forever” categories. Extreme highs are followed by brutal multi-year winters. Harvest your outsized gains aggressively and rotate that money into safer large-caps or stable hybrid assets

Hyper-cyclicals (Metals, Realty, Power, Industrials, Capital Goods)

Trigger: Parabolic short-term spikes (tripling or doubling in 1-3 years)

What to do: Exit. These sectors are pure momentum and business cycle plays. Extreme returns here are the ultimate sign of peak euphoria. Take your money off the table entirely before the cycle turns against you

Defensives & Core sectors

(FMCG, IT, Financials)

Trigger: Detaching from steady long-term averages

What to do: Trim overweight positions.

While these won't collapse as violently as metals or realty, buying after sharp valuation expansion can increase the risk of prolonged subdued returns. Trim down your exposure and redirect the funds into broader, diversified portfolios

Note: This is an indicative rebalancing framework, not an automatic book profit/sell rule. XIRR thresholds are based on historical return behaviour and may not represent future ceilings or turning points. Investors should consider original asset allocation, goals, tax implications, time horizon and risk appetite before shifting gains. Sectoral and thematic exposures carry higher cycle and concentration risks than diversified broad-market allocations.

SIP investors need a similar discipline.

A SIP can remain the route to accumulation, but it should not become an excuse for investing without a destination or review plan. Before starting, define the goal, time horizon, asset allocation and conditions for rebalancing or shifting accumulated gains through an STP. In euphoric or panic-driven markets, such a framework prevents both blind continuation and impulsive exit.

Here is a clear framework (see Table 3). Exceptional returns are rarely a sign of permanent structural growth; they are almost always a signal of peak cyclical euphoria. Crucially, the data prove that when extreme returns flash, the culprits are usually sectoral indices, not the broad market.

While broad indices have strict historical speed limits, sectors can experience dizzying, unsustainable peaks. For example, the highest-ever five-year SIP return for BSE Industrials hit 54.6 per cent, and BSE Realty reached 48.8 per cent.

Broad market SIPs require a completely different set of rules. Because highly-diversified funds represent the broader economy, their historical ceilings are much lower. The data confirm that broad markets (Sensex, BSE 500) almost never breached a 25 per cent XIRR over a five-year period.

Because of these hard historical ceilings, the “euphoria zone” for a large-cap or flexi-cap SIP sits squarely between 18 per cent and 20 per cent. Over the last two decades, whenever a five-year SIP in the Sensex or BSE 500 breached the 18 per cent mark, it reliably signalled a top for returns. If your core equity portfolio hits this number, it is your mathematical signal to stop hoping for more and execute a standard asset-allocation rebalance, sweeping excess equity profits into safer places.

Mid- and small-cap funds carry a much harsher penalty because they behave almost exactly like the highly-volatile thematic sectors. Their historical peaks soar far above the broad market: The absolute highest five-year SIP return for the BSE Smallcap reached a staggering 39 per cent, while the BSE Midcap hit 33 per cent.

Because they are capable of such extreme highs, the cyclical winters that follow are unforgiving. Our historical backtesting shows that when a five-year SIP in a mid- or small-cap index simply crossed the 20 per cent threshold, the median forward three-year return from that exact moment was quite low. So when they deliver outsized 20 per cent+ returns over half a decade, even if they haven't hit their absolute historical maximums, it is a mandate to harvest those gains and rotate into calmer waters.

Table 4

SIP investors should compare entry P/E valuations and returns

	2016 10 years ago	2019 7 years ago	2021 5 years ago	2023 3 years ago	2025 1 year ago	2026 Current
Broad market index						
BSE 500	21.0	27.0	33.7	22.9	24.8	22.8
BSE MIDCAP 150	N.A.	25.4	50.5	25.1	34.7	29.3
BSE SENSEX	18.5	29.1	30.8	23.1	22.6	20.3
BSE SMALLCAP 250	N.A.	29.9	51.5	18.4	31.5	30.8
Sectoral/thematic index						
BSE BANKEX*	1.8	2.6	2.4	2.4	2.6	2.2
BSE CAPITAL GOODS	30	25.1	55.8	32.9	45.2	55.4
BSE COMMODITIES	Negative	14.6	22.6	18.9	31.3	24.3
BSE CONS DISCRETIONARY	26.8	51	60.4	42.4	40	46
BSE CONSUMER DURABLES	15.4	44.4	80.3	60.8	83.9	64.9
BSE ENERGY	13.8	16.3	22.4	12.4	13.4	10.4
BSE FMCG	44.6	45.5	36.9	39.2	42	34
BSE IT	19.1	20.9	28.2	24.7	28.2	20.6
BSE METAL	Negative	8.4	15	11.2	15.9	18.6
BSE OIL&GAS	17.8	11.7	16.3	16	12.9	8.7
BSE POWER	17.9	18.6	16.2	16.5	27.2	38.2
BSE PSU	10.6	20	12.9	9.2	11.9	11.4
BSE REALTY	Negative	26.2	Negative	40.2	50.2	35.9

Source: BSE website/Bloomberg as on May 20, 2026
Negative P/E may indicate cumulative losses for the index

Table 5

Longer SIPs help, but not uniformly

% of rolling SIP instances with negative XIRR

SIP duration	BSE Sensex (%)	BSE 500 (%)	BSE Midcap (%)	BSE Smallcap (%)
1 year	22.71	28.38	31.00	36.68
3 years	6.34	6.83	16.59	24.39
5 years	0.55	2.21	4.97	17.13
7 years	0.64	0.64	2.55	8.92
10 years	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.83

Note: Based on rolling monthly SIP XIRRs in BSE price indices for 20 years ended May 2026. Negative instances are periods with XIRR below zero. Dividends, costs and taxes are excluded; past outcomes may not recur

exposes the ultimate flaw of “lazy investing.” If your SIP has compounded brilliantly over five-seven years, especially in a mid-cap, small-cap or sector/thematic fund, leaving that ballooned corpus entirely at the mercy of the market is mathematically reckless. Negative SIP return instances, though infrequent, do happen even in case of broad-market stock baskets (see Table 5).

RETURNS YOU CANNOT SIP

The danger of sector/thematic investing isn't just about picking the wrong sector. It is actually about picking the right basket at the exact wrong time. An explosive half-decade growth creates the illusion of a permanent structural shift. But a new SIP doesn't buy the last five years and the next five are usually governed by a law of financial physics called ‘mean reversion’.

While the MF industry may not have had a dedicated thematic fund for every single micro-sector back in 2008 or 2011, the underlying index data reveal exactly how these market cycles behaved. Our analysis maps the absolute peak of five-year trailing returns for each sector between 2011 and 2021, and tracked what happened to fresh SIP money over the subsequent 60-month window.

Look at the BSE Auto index. At its peak euphoria in December 2013, investors stared at a staggering 39 per cent five-year CAGR. But an investor starting a five-year SIP on that exact date suffered through a cyclical winter, generating a pathetic 1-2 per cent XIRR on their fresh money. Because much of the money was invested at elevated levels in 2017-18, just before the index fell sharply near the end date.

The cyclical value traps are even more destructive. Investors who saw a respectable 11.7 per cent trailing 5-year CAGR return in PSUs in June 2011 and blindly started a SIP ended up actively destroying their wealth, yielding a minus 2 per cent return over the next 60 months. The Power and Oil & Gas sectors mirrored this exact trend.

Yes, there are exceptions too such as Capital Goods and Industrials. They prove that if a new earnings cycle perfectly aligns with momentum, returns can persist. Whereas in themes like IT, FMCG, and Financial Services, a peaking trailing return reliably signalled that the easy money had already been made.

SIP fixes the habit problem. It does not fix the entry-price problem.

First takeaway is that a SIP in a diversified equity fund is not the same as a SIP in a narrow sector/thematic fund. A SIP started after a broad market correction is not the same as a SIP started after a euphoric category rally.

This brings to our second takeaway. We do not say that investors should avoid strong-performing categories. The real lesson is that trailing returns should trigger questions, not commitment. What drove the return? Was it earnings growth, P/E valuation expansion (see Table 4), policy excitement, liquidity or a temporary cycle? Has the index or category already doubled from its lows?

WHEN TO BOOK PROFITS

Warren Buffett has emphasised his investment decisions which appear sudden are usually the result of a framework built over years: Clarity on why one is buying, what would change the thesis and when one should act.

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

“To build the systems and technologies necessary to make life multiplanetary, to understand the true nature of the universe, and to extend the light of consciousness to the stars”.

What’s that, you ask? That’s SpaceX’s (Space Exploration Technologies) mission statement. The space-telecom-AI giant recently filed its prospectus for an IPO, likely to take place in early June. The mission statement is not all. The prospectus is flush with bizarre stuff like ‘orbital AI compute’, ‘asteroid mining’, ‘energy production on the Moon and Mars’ and other jargons that will make you feel as if reading a sci-fi script straight out of Hollywood. Dabbling in frontier technologies, the company’s ambitions are anything but modest. These are more than just flashy buzzwords — they are formally outlined as part of SpaceX’s growth strategies, though whether its current capabilities can realistically support such ambitions is a different subject.

The IPO price and size are not out yet. But going by media reports, SpaceX is valued at an astronomical \$1.75 trillion, going as high as \$2 trillion in some cases. When xAI was merged with SpaceX in February 2026, the combined entity was valued at \$1.25 trillion. The public issue is likely to fetch the company \$75 billion in fresh capital, making it by far the largest IPO globally. Saudi Aramco’s \$29-billion IPO in 2019 has been the largest so far.

So far, so good. But when you combine the above with the asking valuation, one needs to be grounded in logic than give in to the hype. Here’s why.

To begin with, SpaceX is unprofitable and will be the first unprofitable company to demand over a trillion dollars in valuation, at the time of its IPO. It makes money at EBITDA level, adjusted for share-based compensation and restructuring costs. Assuming an enterprise value (EV) of \$1.75 trillion, the EV to adjusted EBITDA multiple (2025 basis) tests boundaries of the financial universe at about 266x and is plain profane. The price-to-book value multiple (based on Q1 2026 book value) works out to 51x! So, what makes the company so special? Here, we attempt a lowdown of its business and the factors that make it a hard sell, particularly at such sky-high multiples.

BRASS TACKS

Founded in 2002, SpaceX operates across three business segments: Space, Connectivity and AI.

Space: Here, SpaceX designs, manufactures reusable rockets for launch – both for captive (Starlink) and third-party customers including government agencies. In 2015, it was the first company to successfully demonstrate landing of a rocket launched into space back on earth. In 2017, it further demonstrated the reuse of first-stage booster (the part of a multi-stage rocket that gives the propulsion needed to thrust the rocket through the atmosphere and separates from the payload before it reaches the desired orbit). This shaves off a key step in the launch of the next rocket: Rebuilding the first-stage booster from scratch, thus minimising the time gap between two launches. This is known as cadence in rocketry. More frequent the launches over a given period, higher the cadence.

SpaceX’s line-up has three rockets currently. Falcon 9 is the oldest of the three, first launched in 2010. It is the workhorse of the three, having completed 620 of SpaceX’s 650 launches so far, with a payload (what a rocket carries; for example, a satellite) capacity to LEO (low earth orbit – 160-2,000 km above the earth’s sur-



SpaceX and the Big Bang IPO bubble

INVESTORS’ BLACK HOLE.

While the company’s achievements are phenomenal, the demanding valuation relies more on the escape velocity of hype to overcome the gravity of logic

How do financials stack up

	2023	2024	2025	Q1 2026
Revenue	10,387	14,015	18,674	4,694
Adj. EBITDA*	3,821	5,350	6,584	1,127
Net income	-4,628	791	-4,937	-4,276

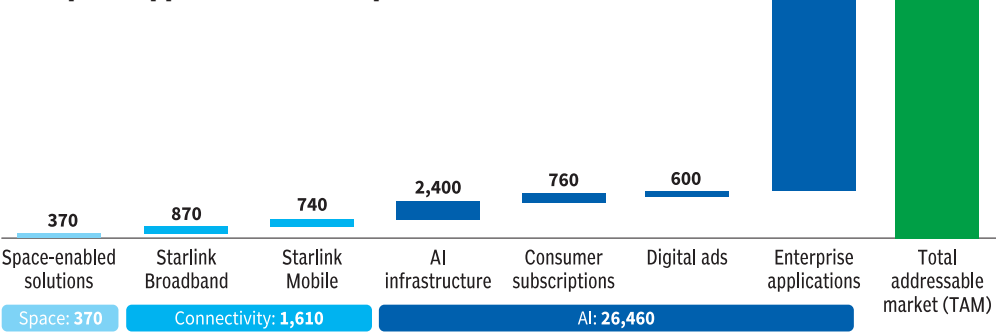
*Adjusted for share-based compensation, restructuring and impairment costs

Drivers of revenue

Segment	2023	2024	2025	Q1 2026
Space				
Mass to orbit (tonnes)*	1,210	1,699	2,213	556
Launches (numbers)	98	138	170	40
Connectivity				
Subscribers (millions)	2.3	4.4	8.9	10.3
ARPU (\$ per month)**	99	91	81	66
AI				
Nameplate compute draw (GW)#	0	0.3	0.8	1

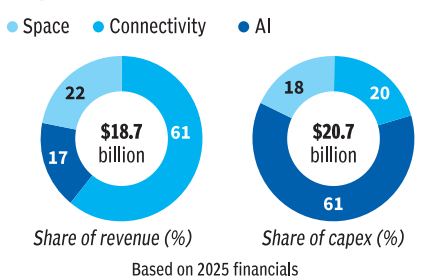
*Total mass of payloads deployed to orbit **Average revenue per user #represents potential capacity of installed GPUs

Enterprise apps form 80% of SpaceX’s TAM



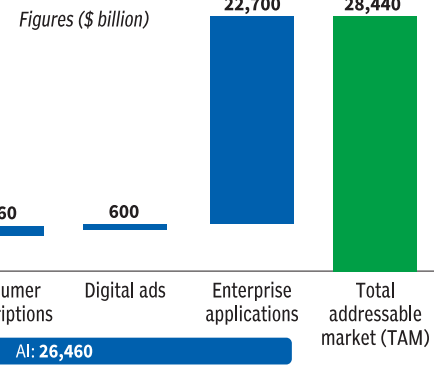
Source: SpaceX prospectus

Segmental breakdown



Connectivity: The cash cow

	2023	2024	2025	Q1 2026
Space	997	1,154	653	-351
Connectivity	1,602	3,849	7,168	2,087
AI	1,222	347	-1,237	-609
Total	3,821	5,350	6,584	1,127



FLASHY BUZZWORDS

The prospectus is flush with bizarre stuff like ‘orbital AI compute’, ‘asteroid mining’, ‘energy production on the Moon and Mars’ and other jargons that will make you feel as if reading a sci-fi script straight out of Hollywood. Dabbling in frontier technologies, the company’s ambitions are anything but modest. These are formally outlined as part of SpaceX’s growth strategies, though whether its current capabilities can realistically support such ambitions is a different subject.

enterprise applications. With AI tech evolving and when it is still not a given that the services sector of today will be taken over by AI in the future, such claims make it sound more like a pipe-dream.

Readers can recall how Musk had forecast x.com’s subscription revenue to hit \$10 billion by 2028, when he was about to acquire the platform in 2022. Today, this languishes at around \$1.4 billion (2025).

Two, ‘establishing a lunar economy’, ‘space tourism’, ‘in-orbit manufacturing’, and ‘asteroid mining’ do sound futuristic and exciting. Musk is even entitled to stock-based compensation (one billion Class B shares) if SpaceX manages to establish a permanent human colony on Mars with at least one million inhabitants (deadline not provided).

But today, these appear more like ‘building castles in the air (or space)’ or a futuristic business plan at best, rather than viable business segments to factor into valuations.

Further, if at all such expeditions are taken up, the case that regulations might never allow them to happen, demands one to be sceptical.

Three, the company is still loss-making. Accumulated losses as of March 31, 2026 (Q1 2026) stand at \$41 billion (book value mentioned above is after considering these losses). One cannot rule out the possibility that the company’s future revenue may not be sufficient to justify today’s heavy capex – a risk that all AI companies face.

Further, xAI is relatively a small player in a space that is already crowded by the likes of Amazon, Google and Microsoft.

Four, SpaceX has entered into frequent transactions with related parties. For instance, in 2025, it purchased \$506 million worth of battery energy storage system (called Megapack) from Tesla – another entity in which Musk is interested. It also purchased \$131-million worth of Tesla Cybertrucks. This follows multiple voluntary recalls of the product by Tesla, some due to serious safety issues such as ‘stuck accelerator pedal’.

xAI has also leased AI infrastructure hardware worth roughly \$4.5 billion from Valor Equity Partners, a firm in which SpaceX director Antonio Gracias is the founder and CEO.

Also as mentioned earlier, X Holdings (x.com or Twitter) was folded into SpaceX — both are entities under Musk’s common control.

Related-party transactions may well be compliant and executed at arm’s length price. However, when there are a material lot of such transactions, a lot in which Musk may have been the beneficiary of, raises eyebrows because of this fact. As of May 1, Musk owns 12.3 per cent of Class A shares (one vote each) and a whopping 93.6 per cent of Class B shares (10 votes each) — together controlling 85.1 per cent of total voting power.

Further, Musk may be removed from his position as CEO/ Board’s Chairman only with the approval of majority of the voting power of Class B shares.

Investors would do well to choose caution over excitement, given the extortionate valuation.

TAX QUERY.



SUDHAKAR SETHURAMAN

Is withdrawal from NPS Tier II equity fund taxable as long-term capital gains (LTCG) at 12.5 per cent when held for more than one year or as income from other sources at slab rates?

Murli Krishnamurthy

Under the Income-Tax Act, 2025, units held in an NPS Tier II constitute capital assets, and gains arising on withdrawal are chargeable to tax under the head “Capital Gains”.

Depending on the holding period, this could be regarded as long term or short term.



For withdrawals made on or after July 23, 2024, NPS Tier II units qualify as long-term capital assets only after a 24-month holding period.

Gains on such long-term holdings are

taxable at 12.5 per cent without indexation.

On the other hand, if units are redeemed before completing 24 months, the gains are treated as short-term capital

gains and taxed at the applicable income-tax slab rate.

Although NPS Tier II account may be fully invested in equities, units issued under the NPS are not treated as equity mutual fund units for tax purposes.

Hence, while classified as capital assets, NPS Tier II (equity scheme) units do not qualify for exemption such as shorter holding period for determining long term or short term — 12 months and ₹1.25 lakh exemption threshold limit, which are applicable to equity shares or equity mutual fund units.

Accordingly, withdrawal from NPS Tier II equity fund is taxable as short-term capital gains if the units are held for more than one year but less than 24 months and as LTCG if held for over 24 months.

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Passive investing is gathering momentum in India, with investors increasingly weighing index strategies to identify the most efficient route to long-term wealth creation. The Nifty 500, which covers about 92 per cent of listed market capitalisation on the NSE, serves as a broad proxy for the equity market. For many, a single index fund or exchange traded fund (ETF) tracking the Nifty 500 offers a simple, low-maintenance way to gain diversified exposure.

Yet, a *bl.portfolio* analysis shows that a structured mix of the Nifty 50, Nifty Next 50, Nifty Midcap 150 and Nifty Smallcap 250 can deliver superior long-term outcomes compared to the Nifty 500 alone. Based on 10-year rolling return data over the last 20 years, the Nifty 500 TRI generated an average CAGR of 12.7 per cent. An equal-weight allocation across the four indices, however, delivered about 14.3 per cent. This indicates an outperformance of 1.60 percentage points that can meaningfully enhance long-term compounding.

For investors starting early, a simple equal allocation across these indices offers exposure across the full market-cap spectrum of large-, mid- and small-caps.

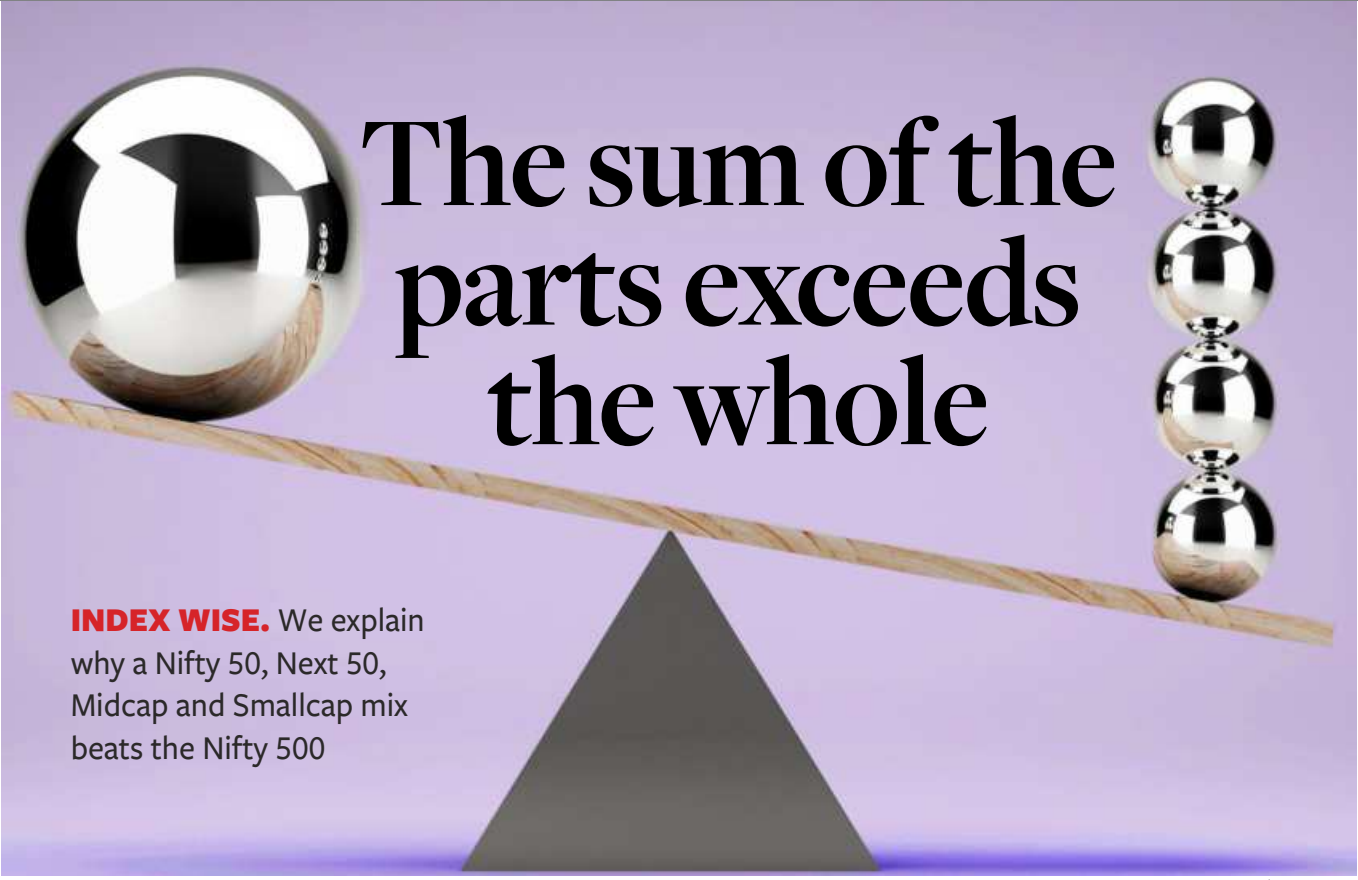
LARGE-CAP BIAS
The limitation of the Nifty 500 lies in its construction. As of April 2026, nearly 57 per cent of the index weight is concentrated in the Nifty 50, with the Nifty Next 50 accounting for another 13 per cent. Mid-caps and small-caps together account for just 30 per cent, at 20 per cent and 10 per cent respectively. In effect, close to 70 per cent of the index is tilted towards the top 100 companies — large-caps.

While this bias lends stability, it also skews the portfolio towards mature businesses where earnings growth may taper over time. In an emerging market like India, mid-sized and emerging companies often contribute alpha, capturing incremental growth beyond large, mature firms.

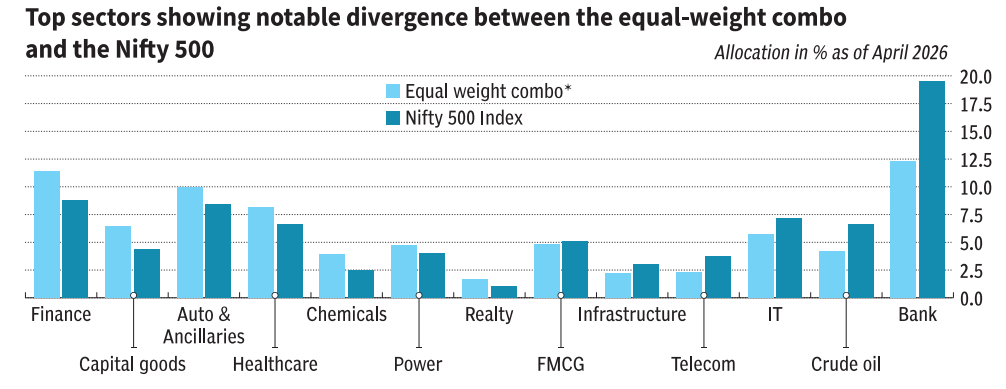
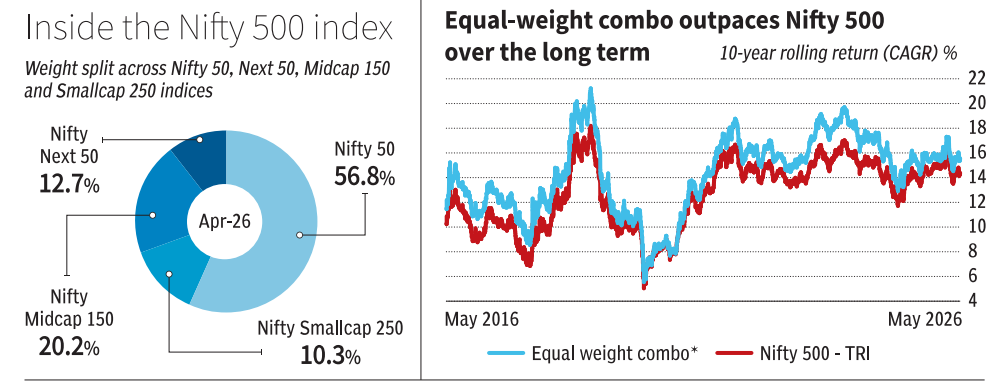
This skew towards large-caps of Nifty 500 is inherent to the free-float market-cap methodology. Because the Nifty 500 weights stocks by free-float market capitalisation, larger companies automatically get a bigger share, creating a built-in large-cap tilt. But for investors seeking true market-wide participation, such concentration can act as a structural drag.

A multi-index allocation helps address this imbalance by distributing exposure more evenly across market segments.

WHY A COMBINATION WORKS
The advantage of this Nifty 50-Next 50-Midcap-Smallcap mix shows up not just in returns, but in sector spread and risk management.



INDEX WISE. We explain why a Nifty 50, Next 50, Midcap and Smallcap mix beats the Nifty 500



Source: ACEMF *Nifty 50, Nifty Next 50, Nifty Midcap150 and Nifty Smallcap 250 indices

Broader sector play: A comparison of sector weights reveals meaningful differences. As of April 2026, banking accounts for 19.5 per cent of the Nifty 500, versus 12.3 per cent in the equal-weight combination, reflecting the index's heavy dependence on large banks. The combination, however, allocates more to broader financials at 11.4 per cent against 8.8 per cent. This captures NBFCs, microfinance and fintech players that are better represented in mid- and small-cap segments. Similarly, the combination carries higher exposure to capital goods at 6.4 per cent against 4.4 per cent, healthcare at 8.2 per cent against 6.6 per cent, automobiles and ancillaries at 10 per cent against 8.4 per cent, and power at 4.7 per cent against 4 per cent. These sectors are closely aligned with India's do-

- KEY INSIGHTS**
- Index combination outperforms the Nifty 500 over long-term
 - Nifty 500 basket is tilted towards large companies
 - Combining multiple indices does require monitoring and rebalancing

mestic growth narrative involving manufacturing, infrastructure and consumption. One can argue that Nifty 500 remains tilted towards more established, old-economy and export-oriented businesses. Additionally, sectors such as business services, education & training, media & entertainment and plastic products

barely exist in the Nifty 500's effective weight. The combination strategy brings these sectors into the portfolio mix.

Better risk management: Unlike the Nifty 500, where large-caps dominate by default, the combination approach allows investors to consciously set their exposure. An equal 25 per cent allocation balances stability with growth by anchoring the portfolio in large-caps, while ensuring meaningful participation in mid- and small-caps. More aggressive investors can increase their exposure to mid- and small-cap indices during favourable cycles, while conservative investors may tilt toward the Nifty 50 and Next 50. Also, unlike market-cap weighted indices that automatically increase exposure after rallies, a combination strategy creates a disciplined rebalancing frame-

work. Indian equities exhibit clear cyclical leadership. Large-caps tend to outperform during global risk-off phases, mid-caps during steady domestic growth, and small-caps in liquidity-driven rallies. The *bl.portfolio* long-term asset allocation grid, too, reflects this trend. A multi-index strategy automatically captures this rotation, improving returns across cycles. No single segment leads indefinitely; the advantage lies in systematic participation across them.

TAKEAWAYS
Around 10 passive funds currently track the Nifty 500 and BSE 500, managing over ₹5,500 crore. While the Nifty 500 remains a convenient and broadly diversified benchmark, its inherent large-cap bias may constrain its effectiveness for long-term, market-wide participation.

A combination approach spanning the Nifty 50, Nifty Next 50, Nifty Midcap 150 and Nifty Smallcap 250 offers a more nuanced alternative. It reduces concentration risk, enhances sectoral breadth and gives investors greater control over allocation and rebalancing.

Also, comparing the yearly returns over the last 20 years shows that the combination strategy outperformed the Nifty 500 in 12 out of 20 periods.

This multi-index approach helps long-term investors earn steadier returns through market ups and downs.

That said, a multi-index combination is more complex than a single index, requiring monitoring, rebalancing and awareness of overlapping exposures. Trading costs, liquidity constraints in smaller indices, short-term underperformance during large-cap rallies, sector concentration and limited historical coverage of extreme events mean disciplined rebalancing is essential.

Bond traders bet on Fed rate hikes this year under Warsh

GLOBAL VIEW. New Governor Christopher Waller's recent remarks confirm the hawkish shift at the Fed

Bloomberg

Bond traders are fully pricing in an interest-rate hike by the Federal Reserve this year, a sign of conviction in the market that Chair Kevin Warsh will need to move quickly to combat inflation.

Traders boosted their bets for higher rates on Friday after Fed Governor Christopher Waller — among the most dovish policymakers over the past year — said that based on the inflation trend, the central bank's next policy statement should "make it clear that a rate cut is no more likely in the future than a rate increase."

Interest-rate swaps repriced to levels anticipating that the Fed's target range for its benchmark rate — 3.5-3.75 per cent since December — will be at least 25 basis points higher by 2026-end, the first time such an outcome has been fully priced.

Waller's comments halted a Treasury market rally, lifting the two-year note's yield as much as six basis points to 4.14 per cent, the highest level since February 2025. The US dollar rose.

"Waller's latest remarks confirm the hawkish shift at the Fed," Evercore ISI Head of Economics and Central Bank Strategy Krishna Guha said in a note. "His discussion of inflation was across the board hawkish."

The shift gathered pace at the

most recent policy meeting in April, when three voters on the Federal Open Market Committee voted against the statement announcing the decision to hold rates steady because it also signaled that that the next move still could be a rate cut.

Short-term interest rate markets fully pricing in a Fed rate increase is a complete turnaround from earlier this year, when President Donald Trump's selection of Warsh inspired Wall Street to bet on at least two quarter-point rate cuts in 2026. Traders began re-calibrating those wagers after the US and Israel attacked Iran in late February.

The resulting effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz disrupted West Asia oil exports, causing gasoline prices to surge. That has led to higher actual and expected inflation rates which, feeding through to other parts of the economy, could force a response from central banks. Sharp increases in energy and food prices in April drove a 3.8 per cent year-on-year increase in the US consumer price index, the biggest since 2023.

INFLATION EXPECTATIONS
In the months leading up to his nomination, Warsh had criticised the Fed for not lowering rates enough and pointed to longer-term dynamics in the economy — namely an expected boom in productivity growth connected to artificial intelli-



BLOOMBERG

- MOOD CHANGE**
- Interest-rate swaps, for the first time, fully priced a Fed target range at least 25 basis points above 3.5-3.75 per cent by end-2026

gence — that might justify cuts. But he hasn't aired his policy views in many weeks. During his confirmation hearing on April 21, lawmakers failed to press him for his near-term views on interest rates.

While Trump at the swearing-in ceremony said Warsh should

act independently, he said he'd be disappointed if Warsh didn't lower rates immediately upon taking the job.

The Fed's next scheduled monetary policy announcement is on June 17, when policymakers are expected to hold rates steady.

Minutes of the Fed's April meeting released this week showed a majority of officials said the central bank would likely need to consider raising rates if inflation continued to run persistently above their 2 per cent target.

A consumer sentiment survey by the University of Michigan showed that inflation expecta-

tions mounted in May. While they remain short of their 2025 highs, respondents' expectations for inflation over the coming year and over the next five-10 years increased more than anticipated, to 4.8 per cent and 3.9 per cent respectively.

GAINS ERASED
Treasury yields were near session lows just before Waller spoke, with the five- to 30-year tenors the lowest in a week. Signs that Iran and the US are close to a peace agreement provided a catalyst for investors to lock in yields near multi-year highs.

The US 30-year rate rose to 5.20 per cent this week for the first time since 2007. It retreated to 5.06 per cent Friday. The UK, German and Japanese 30-year yields also reached multi-year highs.

While previous indications that a lasting agreement was imminent haven't panned out, the potential for developments over the US three-day holiday weekend was a factor.

"While the two sides appear to be a meaningful distance apart in their respective demands, the fact that there is an ongoing dialogue offers some solace," said Ian Lyngen, Head of US interest-rate strategy at BMO Capital Markets in New York.

"There is significant event risk in West Asia as we head into the long weekend."

ALERTS.

ICICI Pru AMC launches two SIF offerings

ICICI Prudential AMC has launched two new Specialised Investment Funds (SIF) segment. They are iSIF Active Asset Allocator Long-Short and iSIF Equity Long-Short. The NFOs close on June 2. For first time investor in SIF, minimum application amount is Rs 10 lakh.

The iSIF Active Asset Allocator Long-Short Fund is an interval investment strategy dynamically investing across equity, debt, equity and debt derivatives, InVITs and commodity derivatives, including limited short exposure on permitted instruments through derivatives. By utilising strategic long-short positioning, the SIF aims to capture opportunities during both bull and bear markets while



carefully managing risk. Allocation is guided by a proprietary four-pillar framework, evaluated daily across market conditions. The SIF aims to capture dynamic shifts across asset classes based on valuations and technical signals. The fund manager's oversight shapes the final allocation based on model.

The iSIF Equity Long-Short Fund is an open-ended equity investment strategy that invests in listed equity and equity related instruments, including limited short exposure in equity through derivative instruments. In an uptrend, the strategy may maintain an aggressive long-equity portfolio to capture higher equity upside, with low or no short-equity exposure. Derivative strategies will remain long-focussed. In a range-bound market, the strategy may take tactical equity exposure alongside opportunistic shorts. Derivative strategies may include call writing and put writing to earn premiums. In a downtrend, the strategy may adopt a defensive portfolio with exposure to low-beta stocks. Short-equity exposure may be increased to manage downside risk and generate alpha. Derivative strategies may include put buying and shorts where the VIX is reasonable.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
as on May 22				
ETF				
Axis Nifty IT ETF	317.0	318.4	4.6	1,059
ICICI Pru Nifty IT ETF	32.0	32.0	4.6	14,041
Aditya Birla SL Nifty IT ETF	31.4	31.6	4.5	859
SBI IT ETF	319.1	319.1	4.4	69
Nippon India Nifty IT ETF	32.0	32.0	4.4	90,700
Mirae Asset Nifty IT ETF	30.5	30.5	4.3	2,632
HDFC Nifty IT ETF	30.7	30.7	4.0	1,327
GOLD ETFs				
Union Gold ETF	153.5	154.2	1.6	80
Bandhan Gold ETF	156.6	157.9	1.4	171
Invesco India Gold ETF	136.4	137.2	1.2	77

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on May 22, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on May 22	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	52.8	12.6	12.0	13.9	76,458
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.5	14.0	13.0	13.7	28,177
Kotak Pension Fund	65.7	13.0	12.6	13.5	4,533
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.5	5.9	5.6	8.2	8,645
SBI Pension Fund	40.8	5.9	5.6	7.7	28,714
HDFC Pension Fund	27.9	5.6	5.3	7.6	51,638
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	29.9	7.3	6.5	8.1	33,770
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.1	7.1	6.3	7.9	13,416
SBI Pension Fund	45.3	7.1	6.3	7.9	15,231
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	45.6	12.7	12.0	14.0	1,834
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.2	13.8	12.9	13.7	791
Kotak Pension Fund	57.7	13.0	12.5	13.4	220

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on May 22, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	11.2	23.2	22.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	853	6.1	19.5	17.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	6.6	20.4	16.2
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-3.9	12.6	15.6
MULTI CAP					
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	117	9.4	29.1	26.1
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	6,992	12.3	37.6	25.1
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	434	12.1	28.4	24.5
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	17.8	30.8	24.5
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,096	16.2	26.2	24.2
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	6.2	21.0	24.2
MID-CAP					
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	9.7	17.5	18.0
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.1	24.4	17.5
Eureka PMS	Signature Approach	NA	7.0	21.3	16.8
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	3.6	16.0	16.5
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,592	40.0	42.0	41.8
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	895	2.6	23.0	36.4
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,278	0.8	31.8	26.3
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	14.9	29.8	23.6

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on April 30, 2026

Solid footing in trying times

BANKING. HDFC Bank’s financials and stable asset quality amid a weakness in the stock, make it a good time to accumulate

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

We had originally given an ‘accumulate’ call on HDFC Bank in July 2024 when the stock was trading at ₹809 (adjusted for bonus issue). Till date, on a point-to-point basis, it has underperformed Nifty Bank with a return of -5.3 per cent while the benchmark’s return measures 6.2 per cent during the same period. This is despite the bank’s resilient performance in FY25-26, having maintained industry-leading asset quality.

Part-time Chairman Atanu Chakraborty’s unexpected resignation in mid-March, citing a cryptic cause — certain practices of the bank had not been in congruence with his personal values and ethics, came as a shocker, given the bank’s systemic importance. Since then, HDFC veteran Keki Mistry has stepped into the role, though temporarily, while the bank has appointed law firms to review the former Chairman’s resignation letter. These developments, among other factors, have weighed on the stock despite the RBI assuring stakeholders that there are no material concerns. Uncertainty over the appointment of the next Chairman and the successor to the current MD & CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan, whose term ends in October 2026, remains an overhang on the stock.

Nevertheless, the bank’s solid fundamentals (FY26 RoA at 1.9 per cent) and the RBI’s reassurance make the recent weakness an opportunity for long-term investors to accumulate the stock at current levels. At ₹766, HDFC Bank trades at about 2x trailing consolidated net worth, a sharp discount to the 2.6x multiple in July 2024 (FY24 RoA at 2 per cent) and 3.9x five years ago. Our conservative sum-of-the-parts valuation is around ₹830, implying an 8 per cent margin of safety. Even without a rerating, growth in book value should support returns. For context, in FY26, the group’s net worth rose 12.3 per cent. With the macro environment likely to remain weak and banks set to directly bear the

● **ACCUMULATE**

HDFC Bank ₹766.40

WHY

- Best-in-class asset quality
- Has good counter-cyclical reserves
- Comfortable valuation

brunt of any stress, quality large banks are positioned to fare better.

FINANCIALS ROUND UP
In FY25, the standalone bank (accounts for about 93 per cent of group net worth) recorded a profit growth of 10.7 per cent. Deposits grew 14.1 per cent, while gross advances grew 5.4 per cent. The bank moderated loan growth to reduce its elevated credit-deposit (CD) ratio, a legacy of the merger with erstwhile HDFC Ltd. The ratio was brought to 97 per cent as of March 2025 from 108 per cent, a quarter after the merger (Q2 FY24).

With the CD ratio easing, the bank shifted back into growth mode in FY26. Advances rose 12 per cent to ₹29.6 lakh crore, while deposits increased 14.4 per cent to ₹31 lakh crore, bringing the CD ratio further down to 95 per cent. While deposit growth exceeded that of the system’s (all commercial banks combined) 13.5 per cent, loan growth trailed the system’s 16 per cent. The management remained cautious on loan growth, viewing the system growth as disproportionate to a likely nominal GDP growth of 9-10 per cent (for FY26), making the bank potentially vulnerable to future delinquencies, if it were to pursue aggressive growth. System credit growth generally happens to be 1-1.2x nominal GDP growth.

Going forward, the bank may not strictly target the CD ratio for advances growth, but may rather let the LCR (liquidity coverage ratio: measures whether the bank has enough liquid assets to survive a 30-day stress scenario; regulatory minimum of 100 per cent), NSFR (net stable funding ratio: simply put, measures



SOTP valuation of HDFC Bank

Business		Methodology	Per share value in ₹
Standalone bank		2x trailing book value	722
Listed	HDB Financial Services	Market value of HDFC Bank’s stake at 20 per cent hold co discount	22
	HDFC Life Insurance		34
	HDFC AMC		31
Unlisted	HDFC Ergo General Insurance*	4x trailing book value	7
	HDFC Securities*	20x trailing PAT	11
Total			827

*Based on P/B and P/E multiples of key listed peers

whether the bank has enough long-term funds (including deposits, bonds and equity; maturing after one year or beyond) to fund long-term assets of equivalent tenor; regulatory minimum of 100 per cent) and CAR (capital adequacy ratio; regulatory minimum of 11.7 per cent) to guide its strategy. The relevance of these ratios over the CD ratio was echoed by the RBI Governor in a recent press conference as well. As of March 2026, HDFC’s LCR, NSFR and CAR stood at healthy levels of 114 per cent, 118 per cent and 19.7 per cent respectively.

Profit, in FY26, grew 10.9 per cent leading to an RoA (return on assets) of 1.9 per cent — as high as in FY25. Asset-quality metrics do not signal any near-term stress. Gross and net NPA ratios are at 1.2 per cent and 0.4 per cent. Credit cost and slippage ratio are contained under 50 bps and around 100 bps respectively. The

bank’s standard assets provisions and other contingency provisions stand at around 1.7 per cent of the loan book.

HDFC’s listed subsidiaries (see table) recorded mid-teen profit growth for the year, while HDFC Ergo posted 62-per cent growth. That of HDFC Securities declined 18 per cent.

LOOK OUT FOR

While the bank’s fundamentals remain strong, it may not be smooth sailing in FY27, and investors need to watch out for the following near-term headwinds.

Corporate loan (27 per cent of the loan book) growth, which has been muted for a few quarters, picked up in H2 FY26. The segment grew 13 per cent in FY26 against a 3.6 per cent decline in FY25. Corporates, which earlier found bank rates expensive, are now tapping bank loans again. Further, the business banking segment (loans to MSMEs; 15 per

cent of the loan book) has been a key engine of growth in recent quarters. In FY26, the segment grew 20 per cent. Given macros could turn challenging in FY27, the management has expressed its cautious stance on these segments. This can impact loan growth and thus trickle down to lower earnings. It is also prudent to factor in some degree of rise in defaults and credit cost, especially driven by MSME, agri and commercial vehicles segments, as they are more vulnerable to macro jitters. However, if the past is any guide, the bank got through the pandemic quarters without any meaningful spike in gross NPA ratio.

Moving on to margin, NIM (net interest margin) stood at 3.5 per cent for Q4 FY26 — only at a 10-bps discount to that for Q3 FY25, the quarter before the RBI started cutting rates. Both yield on assets and cost of funds have undergone an equal 50-bps cut between these two quarters, implying that the repricing cycle on both advances and deposits may be largely over. Deposit repricing may still have some legs, probably continuing into FY27, going by the management’s assessment. If that be the case, NIM could improve a bit. However, one has to consider this.

Deposit mobilisation has been challenging in the last few months, brought about by system credit growth outpacing deposit growth, among other causes. Rates have hardened to stay competitive. This is evident from the system-level weighted average domestic term deposit rate for fresh deposits having undergone a mere 50-bps drop since the RBI’s rate cuts (125 bps cumulatively) started in February 2025 as against a 100-bps drop in weighted average lending rate on fresh loans. Things could get complicated if the RBI raises policy rates in one of the upcoming MPC meetings. However, if that were to happen, about 60 per cent of the HDFC’s loan book linked to external benchmarks (repo rate, T-bill rate) would reprice immediately, padding the margin. The net impact of these opposing forces on margins remains to be seen.

The pulse rate is stable and strong

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Global Health, which operates the premium hospital chain Medanta, is well-positioned for growth over the next three-four years, supported by its established hospitals and upcoming capacity additions. The stock is currently trading at 46x one-year forward earnings, in line with its five-year historical average and broadly comparable with peers. While the valuations are not cheap, corrections can provide opportunities at lower valuation levels. This is given the fact that the sector has many structural drivers of strong demand, a modest pricing lever and underpenetrated market.

Hence we recommend that investors accumulate the stock on dips based on three key factors: Sustained growth in the hospital industry, driven by volume and pricing; limited impact of global uncertainties on operations and expansion plans; and Medanta’s ability to drive growth through improved efficiencies and network expansion.

The company has its flagship hospital in Gurugram (1,440 beds), and later expanded to Indore (175), Ranchi (310), Lucknow (950), Patna (650), and Noida (550) — operationalised in November 2025.

NEAR-TERM DRIVERS

The portfolio can be viewed as mature hospitals: Gurugram, Indore and Ranchi – the ones with more than six years of operations, and developing hospitals: Lucknow, Patna and Noida.

The company plans to increase bed capacity by 13 per cent in FY27 through additional beds at Indore, Lucknow, Noida and Patna. The Indore expansion will be supported by an acquired unit located near Medanta Indore, while the other three, being relatively newer facilities, will continue to scale within their existing infrastructure.

Medanta will also introduce the remaining departments across these units. For instance, departments such as Pediatrics, Obstetrics, Liver Transplant and



HEALTHCARE. Medanta banks on improved efficiencies and network expansion plans

Oncology in Noida. Importantly, the FY27 bed addition is neither a greenfield nor a conventional brownfield expansion, but rather an expansion of services within existing infrastructure, with support and clinical staff already in place. Consequently, this capacity addition is expected to accelerate volume growth faster than a new unit and support margin improvement through better asset utilisation.

ALOS AND ARPOB
The company can supplement the low double-digit volume growth expected in the near term with 4-6 per cent year-on-year growth in realisations or ARPOB (average revenue per bed). Recently, CGHS (Central Government Health Scheme) revised rates and this will imply upward revisions in other government or PSU-sponsored schemes, which together (CHGHS/ECHS/Railways and PSUs) account for 36 per cent of FY26 revenues for Medanta. The improved product mix in new hospitals, private insurance periodic revisions, improving international patient mix (7 per cent of FY26 revenues) are other levers to support modest growth in ARPOBs.

On the profitability front, while Noida is expected to break-even in FY27, the profitability of developing and mature units is expected to improve. Medanta improved its ALOS (average length of stay) from 3.8 days in FY22 to three in FY26. A shorter

● **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS**

Medanta ₹1,238.5

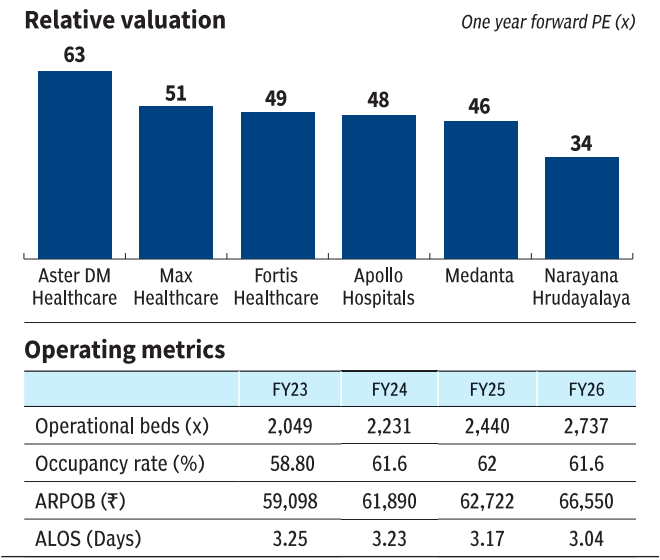
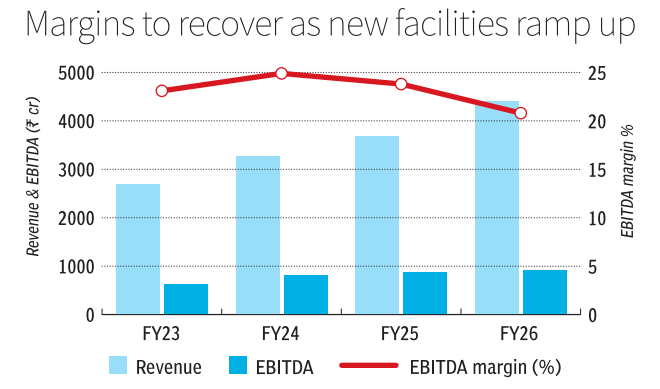
WHY

- Improving asset utilisation of developing units underway
- Hospitals industry should be resilient to volatility with strong tailwinds
- Valuations in line with peers

stay has a strong impact on financials. Asset utilisation improves, as also ARPOB. The latter benefits, as bulk of the revenue are front-loaded. ALOS can further improve as developing hospitals improve their efficiency. Even in mature or developing units, a higher employment of robotic minimally-invasive surgeries are driving a shorter stay across the hospital industry, which will benefit Medanta as well. As shown in the figure, EBITDA margins have been impacted by losses from Noida and other units, but can improve on higher utilisation.

LONG-TERM CAPEX

For FY30, Medanta is targeting a bed capacity of 6,855 compared to 3,665 in FY26. This is an accelerated target compared to FY24-26 — bed capacity growth of 13



per cent CAGR compared to 17 per cent by FY30. This includes 400 beds in South Delhi in partnership with DLF. A 750-bed unit in Pitampura, Delhi, which is jointly developed, and a 400-bed unit in Varanasi under a lease agreement with a partner.

Medanta will be independently developing a 750-bed unit in Mumbai and a 400-bed unit in Guwahati, Assam. The projects are in early stages of development and will take three-four years to commercialise. The company has estimated a capex plan of ₹4,500 crore for the next five years. Medanta has a current net cash position of around ₹600 crore, with reported operating cash flow of ₹573 crore in FY26. It should finance most projects largely from internal accruals, while it has also indicated debt for some.

FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE
The company reported revenue of ₹4,410 crore in FY26, a 18 per cent CAGR growth in revenues during FY23-26, as shown in the figure. But EBITDA growth in the period at 14 per cent CAGR was lower. With the addition of developing facilities, especially Noida, the EBITDA margin declined from 24 per cent in FY25 to 21 per cent in FY26. But with a strong RoE of 15 per cent, the company should add value from its unit additions in the long term.

Medanta’s growth outlook employs existing infrastructure and new capacity expansion. It has experienced strong growth in Lucknow and Patna facilities, which should be evident for Noida unit as well. The long-term development plan also balances own and partnered projects for a relatively derisked expansion plan.

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Sensex ups & downs				
	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	May 15	May 22		
Infosys	1,118.4	1,174.4	▲	5.0
Trent	4,101.3	4,295.8	▲	4.7
Tech Mahindra	1,370.3	1,421.8	▲	3.8
Axis Bank	1,244.9	1,285.3	▲	3.2
HCL Tech	1,132.7	1,163.8	▲	2.7
TCS	2,263.8	2,317.3	▲	2.4
Bajaj Finserv	1,727.4	1,765.3	▲	2.2
Tata Motors PV	356.6	363.4	▲	1.9
ICICI Bank	1,244.7	1,264.9	▲	1.6
Reliance Industries	1,336.4	1,354.6	▲	1.4
Asian Paints	2,605.5	2,639.0	▲	1.3
Ultratech Cement	11,489.9	11,574.9	▲	0.7
Bajaj Finance	910.3	916.4	▲	0.7
L&T	3,907.5	3,926.9	▲	0.5
Eternal	241.1	242.0	▲	0.4
HDFC Bank	767.8	766.4	▼	-0.2
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,795.7	1,786.5	▼	-0.5
Kotak Mahindra Bank	387.3	384.2	▼	-0.8
M & M	3,122.6	3,082.2	▼	-1.3
SBI	963.0	949.1	▼	-1.4
NTPC	395.0	388.5	▼	-1.6
Bharat Electronics	423.6	416.6	▼	-1.7
Bharti Airtel	1,904.6	1,871.4	▼	-1.7
Maruti Suzuki	13,225.9	12,987.5	▼	-1.8
Sun Pharma	1,880.0	1,845.2	▼	-1.9
Titan	4,168.5	4,081.0	▼	-2.1
ITC	309.5	301.8	▼	-2.5
HUL	2,271.0	2,202.0	▼	-3.0
Tata Steel	216.8	209.2	▼	-3.5
Power Grid	305.9	294.4	▼	-3.8

How sectoral indices moved				
	May 15	May 22	Movement	% change
IT	26,964.3	28,065.4	▲	4.1
REALTY	5,909.0	6,044.7	▲	2.3
TECK	14,646.6	14,976.7	▲	2.3
CAPITAL GOODS	76,826.4	78,316.9	▲	1.9
POWER	7,968.4	8,081.8	▲	1.4
OIL&GAS	26,833.9	27,123.9	▲	1.1
BANKEX	60,489.3	60,904.5	▲	0.7
HEALTHCARE	47,193.1	47,267.5	▲	0.2
METALS	43,385.9	43,350.4	▼	-0.1
AUTO	57,424.7	57,290.4	▼	-0.2
CONSUMER DURABLES	58,162.9	57,857.8	▼	-0.5
PSU	21,176.2	20,972.6	▼	-1.0
FMCG	18,825.6	18,551.0	▼	-1.5

How other indices moved				
NIFTY NEXT 50	69,280.3	69,783.1	▲	0.7
BANK NIFTY	53,710.4	54,055.4	▲	0.6
NIFTY 200	13,596.4	13,675.9	▲	0.6
NIFTY 500	22,531.2	22,651.3	▲	0.5
NIFTY 100	24,572.2	24,669.3	▲	0.4

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 I have been in business for only a couple of decades, but have gained the trust of several global investors who now own almost half my equity.
- 2 More than 10,000 employees, operating out of 800-plus locations across 10 States, power my growth. But 80 per cent of my business still originates from three States in one region.
- 3 My revenues and profits have tripled over the last five years without diluting RoE, which has remained largely stable over the last three, five and 10 years.
- 4 I have disappointed shareholders, delivering negative returns since my IPO, a few years ago.
- 5 While women remain a meaningful part of my customer base, they make up barely 3 per cent of my workforce.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by

Last week’s stock:
Ipsca Laboratories

Last week’s winner:
Abhra Gupta

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,719) and Nifty Bank (54,055) gained 0.3 per cent and 0.6 per cent, respectively, over the past week. The derivatives data suggests that the bearishness seen over the week preceding the last one has moderated, although the charts of both indices continue to show resistance at higher levels.

At the broader level, traders continue to maintain net short positions on both index futures and options, indicating overall market caution. Over the last week, net short on index futures (FII and retail combined) increased 10 per cent to 63,328 contracts and net short on call options was up 21 per cent to 2,35,676 contracts.

However, bearish conviction seem to be easing gradually. While cumulative futures open interest increased in both Nifty and Bank Nifty during the rollover week, the rise came alongside gains in the indices, suggesting fresh long additions in the June series.

That said, the largely range-bound price action over the past week and the inability of both indices to overcome key resistance levels suggest that bullish confirmation is still pending.

NIFTY 50
Nifty May futures (23,744) and Nifty June futures (23,801) were up 0.4 per cent and 0.25 per cent, respectively, over the last week. However, the outstanding Open Interest (OI) of the former dropped from 170 lakh contracts to 144 lakh contracts, whereas that of the latter rose from 33.5 lakh contracts to 91.52 lakh contracts.

On an absolute basis, June futures has seen OI addition greater than the decline in May futures. Given that Nifty June futures was up 0.25 per cent, these factors point to a fresh long build-up. The PCR (Put Call Ra-



F&O TRACKER. Fresh long additions in the June series indicate easing bearish conviction, although broader positioning remains bearish

tio) of Nifty May and June options stayed unchanged above 1.

Despite signs of softening bearishness, the larger picture remains negative.

The chart shows that Nifty futures (Jun) has been oscillating between 23,450 and 23,950 for nearly two weeks. The 21-day moving average lies at 24,050. Therefore, the price band of 23,950-24,050 is a resistance and so long as this stays valid, the bias will remain bearish. We expect the contract to resume the decline, breach the support at 23,450 and drop to 23,000. In case Nifty futures (June) breaks out of 24,050, the near-term outlook can turn positive.

Strategy: Last week, we suggested shorting Nifty May futures at 23,800. Liquidate the short position on May futures now at 23,744 and initiate fresh sell in June futures at 23,801. Target and stop-loss can be 23,000 and 24,150, respectively.

Option traders can retain long on June expiry 23,000-put con-

REQUIREMENTS

- Fresh longs emerge in June futures
- Breakout needed for trend reversal
- Traders can retain the short positions

tract (₹210.30) initiated at ₹250. Target and stop-loss can be ₹650 and ₹95, respectively.

NIFTY BANK

Nifty Bank May futures (54,237) and Nifty Bank June futures (54,433) rose 0.7 per cent each last week. But the OI of May contract decreased from 21.8 lakh contracts to 17.5 lakh contracts, whereas the OI of June series shot up from 5.2 lakh contracts to 14.7 lakh contracts.

Further, the PCR of June options increased from 0.74 to 0.94, indicating that puts outsold last week compared to calls.

The recent change in derivatives positioning in Nifty Bank seems to show a bullish tilt. However, it may be too early to call it a bullish reversal as the chart underlines key barriers ahead.

For Nifty Bank futures (June), there is a resistance band at 54,600-55,150. Until the barrier at 55,150 is invalidated, the bulls cannot claim to have taken control.

At a broader level, the FIIs are holding net short on index futures and index call options.

Nifty Bank futures (June) may fall to 51,800 in the near term. Support below 51,800 is at 51,500. If the contract surpasses 55,150, it can extend the upswing to 56,750 and 57,000.

Strategy: Go short on Nifty Bank futures (June) at 54,800. Target and stop-loss can be 51,800 and 55,400, respectively.

Option traders can hold on to June expiry 52,000-put long (₹509.80) initiated at ₹600. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,200 and ₹300, respectively.

also carries the highest time value and is also most sensitive to changes in volatility. That means the ATM strike will lose the most time value (time decay) with each passing day. It is the trade-off between time decay and delta gains that determines the trading gains when closing a position.

OPTIONAL READING

If you were to trade options and prefer to go long, then choosing the ATM strike would be meaningful. Whether you want to initiate a plain-vanilla long position, or a spread depends on whether you have identified resistance (support) level for the underlying while setting up call spreads (put spreads).

The above discussion alludes to an important point: you can trade options without applying the BSM model to create your strategies, but your reading of price charts is important.

The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments

Trading without a model

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Options can be traded without BSM, but chart-reading remains key

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed whether a trader should apply the Black-Scholes-Merton (BSM) model to trade options. We showed that BSM model is useful when you want to understand the theoretical underpinnings about options.

Once you gain trading experience, you will have an intuitive understanding of how to create strategies and how to adjust or repair your strategies when they incur losses. This week, we discuss how you can incorporate options Greeks into your strategies without applying the BSM model.

MODEL BENEFITS

Typical valuation models enable us to compare the output value with the actual price in the market. If the actual price is lower than the output value, then the asset is worth investing. But that argument does not hold water for options.

The BSM model makes as-

sumptions that do not hold in the real-world market.

So, the output value cannot be compared with the actual price to arrive at a meaningful decision. That said, the BSM model can be used by beginner-traders to understand how to choose strikes and how change in time, volatility and underlying price affect option prices.

The sensitivity of the option price to these factors is captured by option Greeks — theta, vega, delta and gamma.

But how to incorporate option Greeks into your strategies without applying the BSM model? You must first determine the at-the-money (ATM) option. The ATM strike is the one immediately above the underlying price. It is most sensitive to factors that affect an option price.

This is because a change in the underlying price can make the ATM strike either in-the-money (ITM) or out-of-the-money (OTM). When a strike moves from ATM to ITM, it will generate handsome gains, as the ITM



PRACTICAL LIMITS

BSM model makes assumptions that do not hold in the real-world market. The output value cannot be compared with the actual price

strikes also carry intrinsic value. That means the change in delta (captured by the gamma) is the highest for an ATM strike. The flip side is that the ATM strike

Range-bound but weak

BULLION CUES. Breakdown risk remains

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Prices of precious metals moderated in the global market. Gold (\$4,509.50/ounce) and silver (\$75.50/ounce) were down 0.7 per cent each.

But in the domestic market, prices stayed flat and gold futures closed at ₹1,58,679/10 gm and silver futures ended at ₹2,71,846/kg.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,58,679)

Gold futures (Jun) was oscillating in the ₹1,57,650-1,60,300 band over the last week. Nevertheless, the outlook remains weak.

Once the fall begins, gold futures can touch ₹1,48,500. The next support is at ₹1,40,000. But if the contract rallies, it can be capped at ₹1,63,000. If this level is breached, the uptrend can extend to ₹1,68,000.

Gold in the international market is weak and so, a rally in price is less likely.

Trade strategy: Last week, we suggested going short on gold futures (Jun) at ₹1,58,550. Hold on to this trade and maintain



stop-loss at ₹1,65,000. When the price drops to ₹1,53,000, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,55,000. Exit at ₹1,48,500.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,71,846)

Silver futures (Jul) was moving within the ₹2,66,000-₹2,77,000 band over the past week. We expect the contract to break down below ₹2,66,000 and witness another leg of a downturn.

A breach of ₹2,66,000 can drag silver futures to ₹2,50,000. If the contract rises above ₹2,77,000, it will face resistance at ₹2,88,000.

Overall, as it stands, the bears are having the upper hand.

Trade strategy: Short silver futures if it inches up to ₹2,85,000 for a better risk-reward ratio. Initial stop-loss can be ₹3,05,000. Book profits at ₹2,50,000.

Positive bias holds

CRUDE CHECK. Rally may resume

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices moderated last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$103.50/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹9,168/barrel) were down 5.2 and 5.3 per cent, respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$103.50)

Brent crude oil futures rallied early last week and hit a high of \$112.72 on Monday. However, it fell during the second half of last week. That said, the price remains above the 50-day moving average and the crucial \$100.

There is a good chance for Brent crude futures to see a rally from the current level. Once the uptick occurs, the contract can retest the barrier at \$115. A breakout of this can lift the contract to \$125.

If there is a decline, it will most likely be arrested at \$94. A breach of this can turn the outlook weak.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹9,168)

Crude oil futures (Jun) hit a high of ₹10,150 last Tuesday. How-



ever, it could not see a follow-through rise.

In the last three sessions, the contract witnessed a considerable fall, leading to a weekly loss of over 5 per cent.

But the support at ₹9,000 remains valid and below this is the 50-day moving average at ₹8,690. Also, ₹8,200-8400 is a notable demand zone. Until these levels hold, the bias will remain bullish.

A potential resumption in rally can lift the contract to ₹11,000. In case the support at ₹8,200 is invalidated, the outlook can become bearish.

Trade strategy: Last week, we suggested buying crude oil futures at ₹9,200. Retain this trade. Target and stop-loss can be ₹11,000 and ₹8,200. When the price rises to ₹10,000, tighten the stop-loss to ₹9,500.

F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

I bought 7000-CE (June) on ABB at ₹110. What is the outlook of the stock? Shall I hold the option or exit?

Varun Dev

ABB (₹6,689.50): The stock, which was on a decline since the final week of April, was consolidating between ₹6,215 and ₹6,450 recently. Last Wednesday, the stock broke out of ₹6,450. The broader trend is bullish and the chart now indicates that the stock has resumed the uptrend. Therefore, the likelihood of a rally from the current level is high. In the near term, we expect the price to hit ₹7,200.

When stock price goes up to ₹7,200, the premium of 7000-call of June expiry, now at ₹131.65, can rally to ₹230-250 range depending on how quickly the rise happens.

Therefore, you can consider holding the option for a target of ₹230. That said, in case the stock slips below ₹6,450, the bears could regain traction, potentially leading to a deeper decline. Hence, exit 7000-call at the ongoing price when the stock breaches the support at ₹6,450.

Delhivery has broken the support at ₹450. Do you suggest buying put options?

Saran Raj

Delhivery (₹447.60): The stock has been in a downtrend over the past three weeks. On Friday, it broke down below a key support at ₹450, which has been holding well since early April.

But there is another minor support at ₹440 and only a clear breach of this increases the odd for a fresh leg of fall. Notable support below ₹440 is at ₹425 followed by ₹410.

If you have higher risk tolerance, you can buy put now. But if you want to go in with better certainty, you can wait for the stock to fall below ₹440. With respect to strike and expiry, we suggest buying June ₹400-strike put. Target and stop-loss can be based on the underlying. That is, exit the put (book profit) at the prevailing price when the stock price falls to ₹430. But if the stock recovers and surpasses ₹455, liquidate the put (exit with loss) at the going price.

✉ Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on May 22	Weekly change %	As on May 22	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	43530	22	254325	-2
Future Index Short	268522	6	92661	-8
Net Futures	-224992	4	161664	2
Index Call options Long	653857	23	2644777	-9
Index Call options Short	815806	3	2718504	-5
Net Call options	-161949	-37	-73727	-218
Index Put options Long	926504	2	2446220	0
Index Put options Short	532543	4	3083482	-2
Net Put Options	393961	1	-637262	-7

FIIs have marginally increased net short on index futures. But they have cut net short on index calls and there is not much change in outstanding net long on index puts.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on May 22)				
BOSCHLTD	36,065.00	-4.4	9.0	98.2
AMBER	7,359.00	-13.2	84.5	96.6
PIIND	2,781.00	-10.7	79.9	84.3
NYKAA	277.25	1.8	955.3	50.1
PAGEIND	39,455.00	7.2	5.6	49.8
FALL (as on May 22)				
KAYNES	3,321.40	1.5	98.1	-31.5
TATAELXSI	4,311.10	4.5	38.2	-19.9
MUTHOOTFIN	3,296.70	-0.4	99.7	-18.2
UNIONBANK	160.72	-0.8	2128.2	-16.4
DRREDDY	1,307.20	-2.2	378.1	-15.4

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on May 25)

KAYNES	SAIL
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
		(Weekly change %)		
COMMODITIES (as on May 22)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Jun	383.6 (1.4)	2,993 (128)	Long build-up
COPPER	30-Jun	1,362.7 (0.3)	11,923 (39)	Long build-up
CRUDEOIL	18-Jun	9,168.0 (-5.3)	14,972 (50)	Short build-up
CRUDEOILM	18-Jun	9,168.0 (-5.3)	31,135 (2)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,58,679.0 (0.1)	5,598 (-23)	Short covering
GOLDGUINEA	30-Jun	1,28,556.0 (-0.4)	8,967 (34)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Jun	1,58,133.0 (0.0)	35,994 (-8)	-
GOLDPETAL	30-Jun	16,092.0 (-0.5)	1,41,854 (36)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Jun	1,60,094.0 (-0.5)	16,944 (25)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Jun	206.0 (0.7)	286 (32)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Jun	291.1 (-3.2)	15,059 (235)	Short build-up
SILVER	3-Jul	2,71,846.0 (0.0)	9,476 (15)	-
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,76,001.0 (0.4)	20,711 (17)	Long build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,76,039.0 (0.4)	52,335 (7)	Long build-up
ZINC	30-Jun	367.3 (1.8)	1,575 (111)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on May 22)				
USDINR	26-May	95.67 (-0.1)	29,18,270 (17)	Short build-up
EURINR	26-May	111.34 (-0.5)	29,304 (3)	Short build-up
GBPINR	26-May	128.59 (0.2)	31,654 (-1)	Short covering
JPYINR	26-May	60.17 (-0.7)	128 (-68)	Long unwinding

F&O Strategy

Long strangle on HPCL

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) (₹389.65) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate supports are ₹369 and ₹331. The nearest resistances are at ₹415 and ₹467. Though long-term outlook is positive, we anticipate higher volatility in the short term.



F&O pointers: HPCL May futures closed at ₹389.80 and June futures at ₹392.05. Both maintain a premium over the spot close of ₹389.65. HPCL witnessed a healthy roll over of 60 per cent to next June series and the higher premium indicates roll over of long positions. Option trading indicates that the stock could move in the ₹380-420 range.

Strategy: Consider long strangle on HPCL by buying June 350-put and June 440-call options simultaneously.

The 350-put and the 440-call closed at a premium of ₹4.40 and ₹4.65, respectively, on Friday. Since the lot size is 2,025 shares, this trade will cost ₹18,326.25 for a combined premium of ₹9.05 (₹4.40 plus ₹4.65).

The total premium paid i.e., ₹18,326.25 will be the maximum loss, which will happen if the stock is stuck between the two strike prices. We advise traders to hold the position with a stop loss at ₹3.5 (combined premium) and aim for ₹18 (combined premium).

Follow-up: Stop-loss would have triggered in Crompton Greaves Consumer long futures.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

Short Take

Weather derivatives out

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

The National Commodity & Derivatives Exchange Ltd (NCDEX) announced on May 20 the launch of weather derivative contracts (futures only), enabling traders to take exposure to weather. Particularly, the rainfall in Mumbai on which the contracts are based on, called RAINMUMBAI. Trading begins on May 29.

The underlying is deviation LPA (Long Period Average) i.e., how the actual rainfall varies from the 30-year average (1991-2020), sourced from Indian Meteorological Department (IMD).



The tick size will be 1 mm of rainfall deviation with a lot multiplier of ₹50 per mm. So, every 1 mm move translates to ₹50 profit/loss per lot. If you're long and the cumulative rainfall runs 10 mm above the LPA, the contract rises by 10 units, or a profit of ₹500 (₹50 per mm multiplied by 10 unit move). Opposite holds for shorts.

The index debuts at a base value of 2,206 points, giving a contract value of ₹1,10,300. As margin is fixed at 10-12 per cent, traders need ₹11,000-13,300 per lot to participate. Trading hours are 10 am to 11:30/11:55 pm and all trades are cash settled. Max allowed order size is 50 lots. On DPL (Daily Price Limit), the initial slab will be 6 per cent expandable by another 3 per cent. FSP (Final Settlement Price) will be the underlying spot value arrived on next calendar day of last trading day.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index were stuck in a narrow range all through last week. The benchmark indices have not gone anywhere in the past 10 days. Broadly, the near-term picture is slightly unclear. Market can go either way from here. So, it is better to stay out of the market and just watch the movement until a clarity is obtained. Key resistances are ahead. The benchmark indices have to breach this hurdle to turn the sentiment positive. Else, they can remain vulnerable to fall more in the short term.

FPIS SELL
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) sold Indian equities for the fifth consecutive week. However, the quantum of selling was relatively low last week. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$555 million last week.

NIFTY 50 (23,719.30)
Short-term view: The index has been stuck between 23,250 and 23,860 for the last 10 days. Key resistance is around 23,900. Nifty has to breach this hurdle to ease the downside pressure. Only then a rise to 24,300 and 24,700 will come into the picture.

As long as the Nifty stays below 23,900, there is a danger of breaking below 23,250. Such a break can drag it down to 22,750 or even 22,350 in the short term.

Medium-term view: There is no change in the broader picture. The index remains well within its broad 22,000-26,500 range and is now moving up within it. The bias remains positive to see a bullish breakout above 26,500 eventually. That will boost the momentum and take the Nifty up to 28,000-30,000 in the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the Nifty declines below 22,000. If that happens, a fall to 21,000-20,000 will come into the picture. However, for this fall to happen, fresh negative trigger is needed.

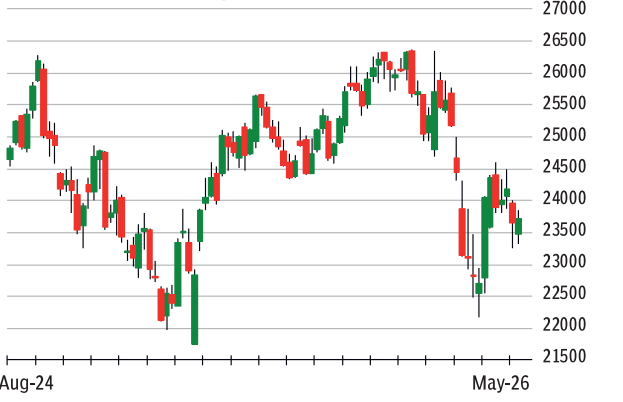
NIFTY BANK (54,055.35)
Short-term view: Nifty Bank index has been oscillating around the crucial support level of 53,700. Key resistance is around 55,100. Support is at 52,750. A breakout on either



INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index are stuck in a narrow range

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Nifty 50: Staying afloat



side of 52,750-55,100 will determine the next leg of move.

A break above 55,100 will be bullish to see 57,000-58,000. On the other hand, a break below 52,750 will increase the downside pressure. Such a break can drag the index down to 51,500 or even 50,500. For now, it is a wait-and-watch situation.

Medium-term view: The overall bullish outlook is intact. Intermediate resistance is around 60,500. A break above it can trigger a fresh rise to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term. From a big picture, Nifty Bank index has the potential to target 68,000-69,000 over the long term.

Nifty Bank index has to decline below 50,000 to negate the above-mentioned bullish view. If that happens, a fall to 49,000-

48,000 can be seen.

SENSEX (75,415.35)
Short-term view: Sensex remains below 76,000. It has been stuck between 74,135 and 75,945. The index has to rise above 76,000 to get a relief rise to 76,500-77,000. However, a subsequent rise above 77,000 is needed to turn the short-term outlook positive. Only then the upside will open up for a rise to 78,000 and higher.

Failure to breach 76,000 can keep the index under pressure to break below 74,135. Such a break can drag the Sensex down to 73,000 or even 71,500.

Medium-term view: Sensex has been oscillating in a wide range of 71,000-86,000. So, even if a fall happens from here, it can be limited to 71,000. The bias re-

IMMEDIATE RESISTANCE

Nifty 50: 23,900
Sensex: 76,000
Nifty Bank: 55,100

mains positive to see a bullish breakout above 86,000. Such a break can take the Sensex up to 90,000 initially and 94,000 eventually in the long term.

A fall below 71,000 is needed to turn the outlook bearish. Only then a fall to 69,000 and lower levels will come into the picture.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,504.20)

The index has risen back sharply after falling to a low of 21,842. The bounce indicates the presence of strong buyers at lower levels. Ideally, the 21,700-21,600 support zone mentioned last week has been holding very well. That keeps our broader bullish view intact.

As mentioned last week, we see high chances to get a bullish breakout above the key resistance level of 23,100 eventually. Such a break will see the Nifty Midcap 150 index rallying to 26,000-26,500 initially and then to 28,000-28,500 eventually in the long term.

A fall below 21,600 is needed to turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, a fall

to 21,300 or 20,800 can be seen. For the long-term bullish view to get negated, Nifty Midcap 150 index has to decline below 20,800. That looks less likely.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (16,775.30)

The fall below the support at 16,450 was short-lived. The index touched a low of 16,272 and has risen back well.

Immediate resistance is at 16,900. A break above it can take the index higher to 17,500-18,000 in the short-term.

As mentioned last week, the region around 18,300 is a crucial resistance. A break above it can boost the bullish momentum. Such a break can take the Nifty Smallcap 250 index up to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the long term.

From a big picture, 14,000 is a strong support. The long-term outlook will turn bearish only if the index declines below this support. But that looks unlikely.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



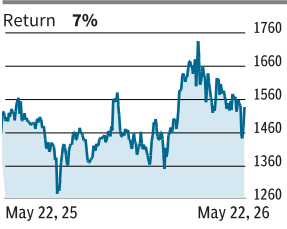
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MOVERS & SHAKERS

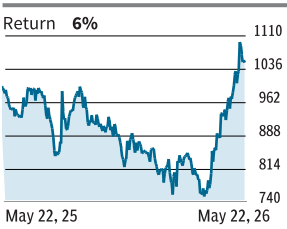
AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

Astral (₹1,543.95)
Hovering near a support



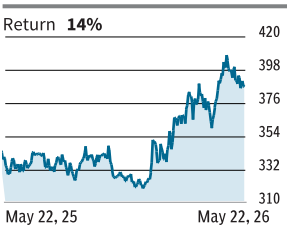
the stock has seen good buying interest in the range of ₹1,470-1,525 since early April. Hence, the probability of a rally from the current level is high. Buy at ₹1,543 and accumulate at ₹1,470. Stop-loss can be ₹1,300. On a rally to ₹1,750 and ₹1,850, raise the stop-loss to ₹1,580 and ₹1,730 respectively. Exit at ₹2,000.

Carborundum Universal (₹1,056.10)
On a steady rise



expected to continue the uptrend and touch ₹1,300. Buy now at ₹1,056 and accumulate at ₹1,000. Place stop-loss at ₹890. When the stock goes up to ₹1,200, raise the stop-loss to ₹1,100. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹1,180 when the price hits ₹1,250. Book profits at ₹1,300.

NTPC (₹388.45)
Rebound expected soon



eventually resume the rally and touch ₹480 in the medium-term. Therefore, traders can go long now at ₹388 and buy more shares at ₹370. Place stop-loss at ₹350 initially. When the price rises to ₹430, raise the stop-loss to ₹400. On a rally to ₹460, tighten the stop-loss further to ₹440. Liquidate the longs at ₹480.

Bullish bias intact

US MARKET OUTLOOK.
Benchmark indices sustain higher and can rise more

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 are continuing to hold higher. The 2 per cent rise in the Dow Jones indicates that the upmove has resumed after the consolidation. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index are stable over the last couple of weeks. Broadly, the uptrend in the US benchmark indices remains intact.

DOW JONES (50,585.07)

The bullish breakout above 50,200 strengthens the bullish case. The Dow Jones can rise to 51,300-51,500 and even 52,000 in the short term. The price action around 52,000 will need a close watch. Failure to breach 52,000 can trigger a corrective fall to 50,000-49,000.

The index has to fall below 50,000 to turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, a fall to 49,500-49,000 can be seen. For now, allow for a rise to 51,500-52,000 and then watch the price action.

S&P 500 (7,473.48)

The fall in the initial part of the week could not sustain. The index fell to a low of 7,333.68 before rising back sharply recovering all the loss. That keeps the broader uptrend intact. Immediate resistance is at around 7,500. The chances are high to see a break above it. Such a break can take the index up to 7,600-7,750 in the coming weeks.

Key support is at 7,250. The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below this support. If that happens, 7,100 can be seen on the downside.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,343.97)

The index has been stuck inside a narrow range over the last two



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BULLISH BIAS

The dollar index is likely to breach 99.45 and rise to 100.50-101.

weeks. The price action on the weekly chart indicates good buying interest around 25,700. That keeps the bias positive. A rise to 26,800 looks likely in the short term. A break above 26,800 can take the index higher to 27,500.

Failure to break 26,800 can trigger a fall back to 26,000-25,700.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (99.32) oscillated between 98.60 and 99.45 all through the week. On the charts, last week's candle indicates indecisiveness in the market.

The level of 98.60 is a good short-term trendline support. So, as long as the index stays above this support, the bias will remain positive. That will keep the chances high for the dollar index to breach 99.45. Such a break will then take the index

higher to 100.50-101 in the short term.

The dollar index has to fall below 98.60 to turn the short-term picture negative. If that happens, a fall to 98.20 and even 97.80 can be seen. Such a fall will also negate the chances of the rise to 101.

As seen from the daily chart, the bias is positive. So, our preference will be to see a rise to 100.50-101.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10 Year Treasury Yield (4.56 per cent) surged to a high of 4.69 per cent, but failed to sustain. It has come down sharply from this high. However, this fall looks like just a correction for now within the broad upmove. An important support is in the 4.55-4.5 per cent region.

A bounce from this support zone and a subsequent rise above 4.6 per cent will be bullish to see a rise to 4.8 per cent. From a big picture, a sustained rise above 4.6 per cent will have the potential to take the US 10 Year Treasury Yield up to 5 per cent in the coming months.

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were up 0.2 and 0.3 per cent respectively last week. BSE IT gained the most by 4.1 per cent, followed by BSE Realty 2.3 per cent and BSE Tech 2.3 per cent. BSE FMCG and BSE PSU declined by 1.5 and 1 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 One [1]	1112.4	29.9	37.2	4.6	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	1.8	14.3	2.0	1273.0	906.2
3M India [1]	32323.0	542.7	61.2	17.5	202603	0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	6.3	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28300.0
A B B [2]	6688.9	71.9	93.1	18.1	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	4.8	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
A B Lifestyle [1]	102.1	1.7	59.7	8.8	202603	11.9	57.7	7.2	29.4	-1.6	11.7	2.3	176.1	87.7
A B Real Estate [1]	1252.7	-27.0	3.8	202603	-79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-605.4	-3.0	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [1]	475.4	25.4	18.7	2.8	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	2.7	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2
Aarti Industries [5]	476.3	11.4	41.9	2.9	202603	13.1	42.7	14.1	25.2	2.2	6.2	0.7	522.9	338
AAVAS Financials [1]	1398.9	61.9	22.6	2.9	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	1.2	9.9	2.2	2152.0	1050.3
Abbott India [1]	2782.2	730.4	38.1	12.4	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	-0.4	0.5	0.3592.1	6251.4	
ACC [1]	1359.3	112.4	12.1	1.2	202603	16.9	62.9	17.3	-9.0	-0.4	17.9	0.0	2027.8	1260.9
ACME Solard Hold. [2]	289.5	8.3	34.9	3.5	202603	1.2	0.9	44.0	87.6	4.9	7.4	2.8	324.3	182.5
Action Const.Eng. [2]	881.3	34.9	25.2	5.2	202603	7.1	-6.5	-1.4	-1.4	-0.8	4.0	0.2	1360.0	74.1
Adani Energy Sol [1]	1368.0	19.0	72.0	6.5	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	4.7	10.1	2.2	1493.0	745.5
Adani Enterp. [1]	2718.0	16.7	162.5	4.4	202603	20.3	-124.0	-2.6	-48.0	0.1	9.0	1.8	2800.0	1753.5
Adani Green [1]	1361.7	11.2	121.4	11.2	202603	3.2	40.7	11.6	8.5	-1.2	9.4	6.4	1472.3	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1786.5	96.3	31.7	4.3	202603	26.5	11.4	17.1	14.4	-0.5	14.0	0.9	1823.1	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	219.3	6.7	33.0	6.5	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-0.9	21.2	0.7	234.4	105.7
Adani Total Gas [1]	653.0	6.0	109.5	14.8	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	6.1	17.4	0.7	797.0	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	1051.8	33.8	29.9	7.2	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	-1.8	35.5	0.0	1125.8	701.8
Affle F&S [1]	67.5	1.5	45.2	1.3	202603	2.9	35.9	4.9	31.9	1.7	10.4	1.4	105.4	33.6
Aditya Birla Cap [1]	357.1	14.5	24.6	2.7	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	0.0	9.5	4.4	375.9	217.1
Aegis Logistics [1]	723.9	21.9	33.0	4.3	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	7.3	14.5	0.9	943.9	576.0
Aether Industri. [1]	1052.4	17.0	61.7	5.7	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	-5.3	9.7	0.1	1274.2	723.2
Aion Healthcare [1]	289.5	28.5	35.4	2.0	202603	-18.9	-73.7	56.8	26.7	-10.9	11.5	0.1	259.1	245.9
Affle 3i [2]	1432.7	32.3	44.3	5.5	202603	20.3	16.0	19.5	19.1	-3.0	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.9
Alia Engineering [2]	4001.6	124.8	32.1	5.1	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	3.9	19.1	0.1	4200.0	3006.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3106.5	84.5	36.7	8.6	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	-2.2	32.0	0.1	3314.8	2335.0
Ambic Pharma [2]	3406.7	20.9	26.9	4.8	202603	4.4	40.8	10.1	26.9	-3.7	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.5
Alkem Labs [2]	5406.7	20.9	26.9	4.8	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	-1.5	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8
Allied Industries [2]	1718.6	35.2	48.8	5.7	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	-0.3	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	536.7	8.2	65.2	9.0	202603	9.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	-3.4	21.0	0.9	720.0	328.7
Altria [1]	12.3	0.4	31.2	1.2	202603	0.1	68.0	10.1	1.8	0.7	11.1	0.1	214.7	10.1
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	820.8	37.4	21.9	1.9	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	-0.4	15.6	0.0	1095.9	671.5
Amber Enterp. [1]	7355.8	27.2	128.7	5.9	202603	10.5	-26.8	22.2	-17.7	-13.2	13.5	0.8	7970.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	436.4	20.0	21.8	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	0.6	12.7	0.0	625.0	349.0
Amar Pathi Wela [5]	3375.0	47.7	75.0	28.7	202603	28.7	46.0	22.3	32.1	0.8	15.8	0.1	3733.9	1822.4

Angel Raj [2]	503.5	15.4	32.7	3.1	202603	19.6	23.6	21.9	3.0	3.2	10.9	0	744.1	403.0
Angel One [1]	339.4	10.0	33.8	5.1	202603	38.2	83.5	19.1	-21.9	0.7	14.8	1.0	455.5	208.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1880.4	43.3	43.4	9.9	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-0.5	22.0	0.2	2303.0	1493.0
Apollo Hospitals [2]	8359.8	136.0	61.4	12.7	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	35.3	3.4	17.5	0.6	8432.6	6489.0
Apollo Tyres [1]	371.9	33.6	11.1	1.4	202603	14.2	254.7	9.0	72.5	-0.7	10.3	0.9	540.3	365.0
Asahi Indus Hou. [2]	260.2	18.6	97.7	2.6	202603	16.0	-26.0	25.5	-17.2	17.6	0.3	0.0	493.0	260.0
Asahi India Glas [1]	855.0	12.3	69.5	5.9	202512	8.4	32.8	5.3	-4.7	43.9	13.1	0.9	970.0	369.0
Aslak Leyland [1]	158.2	0.2	25.6	7.4	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	3.3	14.9	4.3	215.4	115.0
Asian Paints [1]	2639.0	42.6	62.0	12.9	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	13.3	24.4	0.1	2985.1	2156.0
Ashtech Health. [1]	62.0	1.8	97.7	53.8	202603	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.0	100.0	100.0
Astral [1]	1541.0	20.6	74.8	10.2	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	5.6	-0.6	20.8	0.1	1768.1	1260.0
Astrenacebra Pharm [2]	8604.3	83.2	103.4	26.9	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	1.4	32.9	0.0	10653.2	7630.0
Ather Energy [1]	884.7	-13.4	13.2	202603	73	-142.8	62.8	36.9	-57.6	-0.3	1.1	98.94	306.0	0.0
Ather Energy [2]	884.7	-13.4	13.2	202603	73	-142.8	62.8	36.9	-57.6	-0.3	1.1	98.94	306.0	0.0
AU Small Finance	978.3	35.3	20.5	3.7	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	-1.3	0.0	0.0	1079.7	682.0
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1464.7	61.1	24.0	2.3	202603	4.2	2.0	6.4	1.8	-3.1	14.2	0.2	1550.0	1017.0
Authum Invest [1]	510.6	42.8	11.9	2.7	202512	-22.5	-70.2	16.0	-9.5	0.6	29.7	0.1	683.5	400.0
Avanika [1]	145.1	45.5	30.9	11.0	202603	1.2	38.2	5.5	-1.2	0.0	0.0	0.0	493.0	365.0
AWL Agra Business. [1]	195.1	8.2	23.9	1.9	202603	17.7	55.3	17.3	-13.4	-2.4	19.8	0.3	248.5	171.0
Axis Bank [2]	1285.3	84.8	15.1	0.9	202603	5.3	1.7	4.1	-6.0	3.2	0.0	0.0	1183.1	1041.0

B H E L [2]	408.6	4.6	88.9	5.4	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	2.6	3.2	0.4	417.7	205.2
B PCL [1]	295.6	60.3	4.9	1.3	202603	6.7	26.1	3.4	92.1	3.9	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.0
Bajaj Auto [1]	10546.8	385.4	27.4	7.6	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	1.6	28.1	0.2	11078.9	7879.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	916.4	30.8	29.7	5.0	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	0.7	11.4	3.8	912.5	708.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1765.3	62.9	28.1	3.6	202603	6.3	5.0	13.2	13.4	2.2	12.4	4.9	1479.4	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10485.5	736.5	14.2	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	1.8	11.5	0.1	11485.73	8597.0
Bajaj Housing [1]	83.1	3.1	26.9	3.1	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-0.9	9.5	4.7	128.4	72.6
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2209.6	64.3	34.4	3.9	202603	6.6	-18.7	3.6	-24.9	2.9	17.9	0.3	2802.0	2016.0
Balarampur Chini [1]	535.2	18.7	28.6	2.6	202603	6.7	30.4	15.8	13.4	-1.1	11.1	0.1	627.0	393.4
Banque Bank [1]	194.8	7.6	25.6	1.2	202603	-0.1	68.0	1.2	15.6	-0.2	11.5	0.1	168.2	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	265.0	38.4	6.9	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	1.3	0.0	0.0	325.6	230.6
Bank of India [1]	140.1	23.5	6.0	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	-1.5	0.0	0.0	175.5	101.9
Bank of Maha [1]	80.1	9.1	8.8	2.0	202603	15.2	36.1	17.4	26.6	2.6	0.0	0.0	85.9	59.1
Bank India [1]	397.7	40.0	37.1	3.8	202603	4.8	202.1	-0.4	12.4	-1.3	17.9	0.1	539.9	289.8
Bata India [1]	686.7	14.9	46.1	5.8	202512	28.8	10.6	20.3	18.6	-0.2	19.7	0.3	304.5	215.4
Bayer Crop Sci. [1]	1483.4	149.2	29.4	6.3	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	0.8	23.8	0.0	6540.0	4276.1
BEML Ltd. [1]	1829.9	29.9	61.2	5.4	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	2.4	11.7	0.1	2437.1	1361.9
Berger Paints [1]	500.9	10.0	50.1	8.4	202603	6.1	17.3	2.9	-1.2	-6.1	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5
Beta Dynamics [1]	1312.0	15.8	83.0	11.4	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	-12.2	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1290.0
Bharat Electron [1]	416.6	8.3	50.2	12.7	202603	11.7	4.6	16.2	13.9	-0.7	36.9	0.1	473.3	361.1
Bharat Forge [2]	1897.7	24.6	77.2	9.5	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	13.8	-0.8	11.7	0.9	2043.9	1100.5
Bhart Airtel [5]	1871.4	48.2	38.7	7.7	202603	15.7	-12.0	22.0	10.1	-1.7	14.3	2.2	2174.7	1745.0
Bharat Petroleum [1]	1246.1	65.3	41.3	11.8	202603	29.1	42.4	25.2	18.4	-0.3	11.1	0.0	2051.0	1445.8
Bikaji Foods [1]	654.2	35.1	43.9	10.8	202603	5.4	-1.1	9.4	35.6	-1.3	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1438.0
Bikaji Hoesam [1]	154.6	10.4	62.8	10.2	202603	19.0	26.1	15.1	30.2	-2.3	18.4	0.2	802.9	591.6
Biocon [5]	430.3	3.8	112.7	2.1	202603	2.9	-61.6	11.5	-35.4	0.0	6.9	0.8	436.8	37.8
Birla Corp. [1]	1007.5	72.9	13.8	1.2	202603	0.8	-3.6	4.8	72.9	-1.6	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9
BirlaSoft Ltd [2]	1312.0	12.4	107.5	8.8	202603	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	-0.2	19.8	0.1	2397.0	1284.4
BLS Internat. [1]	26.80	16.7	1.61	4.5	202603	17.6	31.6	36.7	35.1	5.9	39.0	0.1	422.9	278.0
Blue Dart Express [1]	4853.5	119.9	40.5	6.5	202603	8.2	-11.3	7.4	12.7	-4.1	17.1	0.7	722.4	469.0
Blue Bird Bus [1]	165.5	1.9	86.9	26.9	202603	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	1.4	0.0	100.0	100.0
Blue Star [2]	1657.5	27.0	61.4	9.9	202603	1.3	10.4	3.6	-1.0	-0.7	25.8	0.1	2050.0	1450.0
Bosch	3605.9	78.94	45.7	7.2	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	-4.4	20.5	0.4	4389.4	3285.0
Brannabes Soft [1]	235.2	10.0	2.0	2.6	202512	11.6	-77.0	12.0	-3.4	-4.8	0.0	0.0	438.7	207.0
Brannabes Soft [2]	235.2	10.0	2.0	2.6	202512	11.6	-77.0	12.0	-3.4	-4.8	0.0	0.0	438.7	207.0
Britannia Inds. [1]	539.9	105.2	5.0	25.2	202603	7.1	21.1	7.5	15.3	-1.3	51.9	0.4	633.7	207.0

Pack peace of mind for foreign trips

A MUST HAVE. War-related contingencies not covered in travel insurance, but most other risks are

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

In the middle of the summer travel season, we highlight the importance of travel insurance for policyholders. A typical travel insurance plan for around a week to the USA costs less than ₹1,500 per person. But ignoring the same for international trips can introduce a significant financial risk even on a short trip. Also, the number of exigencies covered even by the cheapest travel insurance plans makes such a cover all the more necessary. At the outset, we will address the critical question. Travel insurance does not cover war-related triggers for a claim. Flight rescheduling, cancelled hotels or trip cancellations arising from wars, conflicts or government actions are not a basis for claims. Also, travel insurance may be void if the policyholder is travelling to a destination that has been placed under a government travel advisory. But the other ‘regular’ risks covered by travel insurance are comprehensive.

MEDICAL EMERGENCIES
The primary risk is that of falling ill on a foreign trip, considering the cost of healthcare

for the uninsured in a developed country. Travel insurance policies generally provide medical expenses cover of \$200,000-\$500,000. But this cover is for unplanned medical emergencies and the medical care provided will most likely be limited to emergency treatment to allow for travel back home and not comprehensive care. Travel insurance plans also cover medical evacuation, up to the sum insured, to transport the policyholder back home for medical conditions. If the ailment is a pre-existing condition (PED), which must be declared at the time of issuance, the claim may not be supported. But some insurance companies, Tata AIG for instance, cover PED treatment but up to a lower cover of \$30,000 only. In the unfortunate case of death or disability during the trip, plans provide personal accident cover of \$20,000 along with repatriation of mortal remains. Travel insurance plans also accommodate incidentals like a daily allowance during hospitalisation (\$125-\$150 limit), ambulance charges of \$500 and OPD charges for consultations. These factors, while manageable in India, can strain finances in a foreign country.

SIMPLYPUT.

Covering interest coverage ratio

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Two colleagues, Pragathi and Shefali, meet in the cafeteria for lunch. Their conversation turns to Indian equities and one of the few bright spots amid the current turmoil: strong corporate balance sheets. They also discuss the other side of the story — how being too conservative can sometimes limit growth. **Shefali:** I have been sitting on funds without the confidence to invest in equities. The recent statement by the Prime Minister on the need for austerity has further shaken my confidence. **Pragathi:** Same here friend. But I take my chances and always stay invested. Besides, there are few bright spots, which can reassure an investor. Balance sheet strength of companies has been strong, which is reassuring. **Shefali:** Please elaborate. How would you quantify it? **Pragathi:** One of the measures is to simply ask if the assets on the balance sheet are generating enough cash to service the debt and more. Interest coverage ratio can capture that information. Mathematically, it is the ratio of EBIT or earnings before interest and taxes over interest charges. A ratio well above 2x indicates that the company is delivering enough profits to cover interest and more. **Shefali:** Okay. So, what does the ratio now indicate? **Pragathi:** Well, according to my findings, after the Q4FY26 results, around 600 Indian companies that had reported results till the first week of May (excluding banks as banks have high leverage via deposits) have an interest service coverage of around 7.5 times. For a rupee of interest, the companies have generated over ₹7 in EBIT. If one were to stress test Indian companies on financial leverage metrics, I think they will be in a better place. **Shefali:** Yes, that is reassuring. But can you put that in a historical context? **Pragathi:** Then, let’s go down the rabbit hole. In the more recent context, I have



seen this ratio closer to 3.4 times in March 2021: when we were amid a pandemic. But even this is considered a good ratio compared to the absolute zenith of 2010-2012 period. A Credit Suisse analyst had come out with a report – ‘House of Debt’ – in 2012. It was named so because, he said, close to 15 per cent Indian companies had an interest coverage ratio of less than 1. By 2017-18 Indian banks’ NPA ratio was in the 11-12 per cent range. Today, that ratio is less than 1 per cent. **Shefali:** Okay. Seems like Indian corporates have learnt a lesson... **Pragathi:** Yes, they have. In fact, on the flip side, Indian companies are now too conservative – at the cost of growth. Interest coverage has been constantly rising in the

last five years and not because EBIT margins have outperformed. They rose because debt has been underemployed by companies. At some point, investors and current valuations will force companies to pursue growth. It is better for companies to assume a certain degree of manageable risk (debt) before their hand is forced and they announce a Corus style acquisition that backfires. And to be fair, this appears to have thankfully started. Banks now cite commercial and corporate as the fast-growing segments in their loan books over home and retail segments. **Shefali:** As famous economist Shakespear said, To be (in debt) or not to be, that is a question companies will ask once the skies are clear I believe.

Safe Investing • bl • 9

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme	Interest rate (%)		
	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	Compounding frequency
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0
	1 year	6.9	6.9
	2 year	7.0	7.0
	3 year	7.1	7.1
Post Office Time Deposit	5 year	7.5	7.5
		6.7	6.7
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)			Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme			Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme			Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate			Annually
Public Provident Fund			Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra			Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana			Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, GoI

ALERTS.

PFRDA to expedite subscriber grievance redressal

In a move to enhance subscriber protection, the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA) has released an exposure draft proposing significant amendments to its 2015 Redressal of Subscriber Grievance Regulations. The primary objective is to drastically reduce grievance resolution timelines and align the framework with financial sector best practices.



VAIBHAV JEWELLERS Relationships, By Design MANOJ VAIBHAV GEMS 'N' JEWELLERS LIMITED CIN: L55101AP1989PLC009734 Registered Office: 47-15-8, V Square, Zone-A, Opp: TSR Complex, Station Road, Dwarakanagar, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh, India, 530016 Corporate Office: Door No. 47-10-19, 2nd Lane, Dwarakanagar, Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh, India, 530016					
EXTRACT OF AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND TWELVE MONTHS ENDED MARCH 31, 2026 (PURSUANT TO REG 47 (1) (B) OF SEBI LODR REGULATIONS, 2015) (Rs. In Crores)					
Sl. No.	PARTICULARS	THREE MONTHS ENDED		YEAR ENDED	YEAR ENDED
		31-03-2026 (Audited) (Refer note no 4)	31-12-2025 Unaudited	31-03-2025 (Audited) (Refer note no 5)	31-03-2025 Audited
1	Total income from operations	764.93	686.27	707.49	2,759.22
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	37.46	45.10	36.18	155.36
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	37.46	43.66	36.18	153.92
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	28.16	34.50	26.75	114.98
5	Total comprehensive income for the period (comprising profit / (loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax))	28.03	34.49	26.73	114.60
6	Equity Share Capital	48.85	48.85	48.85	48.85
7	Reserves (Excluding Revaluation Reserves)	-	-	-	784.51
8	Earnings Per Share (of Rs.10/- each) for continuing and discontinued operations (not annualized for 3 months ended)	5.76	7.06	5.48	23.54
	Basic:				
	Diluted:	5.76	7.06	5.48	23.54
Notes: 1. The audited financial results for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 have been reviewed by the audit committee of the Board and approved by the Board of directors at their meeting held on May 22, 2026. 2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulations 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on company's website at www.vaibhavjewellers.com and the stock exchanges website www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com . 3. The Company is engaged in the retail business of Jewellery. As the Company's business activity falls within a single business segment, there is no separate reportable segments as per Ind AS 108 "Operating Segments". 4. The financial results for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of year ended March 31, 2026 and unaudited published figures in respect of nine months' period ended December 31, 2025. 5. The financial results for the quarter ended March 31, 2025 are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of year ended March 31, 2025 and unaudited published figures in respect of nine months' period ended December 31, 2024.					
FOR AND ON BEHALF OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS SD/- GBM RATNA KUMARI CHAIRPERSON & MANAGING DIRECTOR DIN: 00492520 Place: Visakhapatnam Date: May 22, 2026 					

Sakthi Finance Since 1995 SAKTHI FINANCE LIMITED (CIN : L65910TZ1955PLC000145) Regd. Office : 62, Dr. Nanjappa Road, Coimbatore - 641 018 Ph : (0422) 4236200 Fax : (0422) 2231915 E-mail : investors@sakthifinance.com Website: www.sakthifinance.com Extract of Statement of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Year ended 31 March 2026 (₹ Lakh)					
Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.12.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)
Total Revenue from Operations (net)	4,927.89	5,481.14	5,269.88	21,070.54	21,498.88
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before tax and Exceptional Items)	667.93	545.33	614.52	2,340.06	2,333.13
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional Items)	667.93	545.33	614.52	2,340.06	2,333.13
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional Items)	561.77	375.07	459.39	1,724.90	1,665.15
Other Comprehensive Income (net of tax)	(14.58)	(5.86)	(38.42)	(24.49)	(35.16)
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (net of tax)]	547.19	369.21	420.97	1,700.41	1,629.99
Paid-up equity share capital (Face value : ₹ 10 per share)	6,470.59	6,470.59	6,470.59	6,470.59	6,470.59
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	-	-	-	15,324.92	14,098.92
Securities Premium	1,429.80	1,429.80	1,429.80	1,429.80	1,429.80
Net worth	20,477.89	20,524.07	19,976.54	20,477.89	19,976.54
Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt	0.60	0.60	0.51	0.60	0.51
Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Debt Equity Ratio	5.47	5.87	5.53	5.47	5.53
Earnings per share (₹ 10 each) (for continuing operations) :					
a. Basic (₹)	0.87	0.58	0.71	2.67	2.57
b. Diluted (₹)	0.87	0.58	0.71	2.67	2.57
Capital Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Debenture Redemption Reserve	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

Notes :
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statement of Audited Financial Results filed with Stock Exchange under Regulations 33 and 52 read with Regulation 63(2) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015. The full format of the Audited Financial Results are available on the BSE Ltd website (URL:www.bseindia.com/corporates) and Company's website, www.sakthifinance.com. The Audited Financial Results can be accessed by scanning the QR code given below.
2. Disclosures in accordance with Regulation 52(4) read with 63(2) of the Listing Regulations have been submitted to BSE Limited and the disclosures can be accessed on the BSE website (URL : www.bseindia.com/corporates) and Company's website, www.sakthifinance.com and it can be accessed by scanning the QR code given below.

23 May 2026
Coimbatore - 18



By Order of the Board
For Sakthi Finance Limited
M. Balasubramaniam
Vice Chairman and Managing Director
DIN : 00377053



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	59.6	16542	1.4	0.5	-3.8	11.5	10.5	13.7	0.33
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	106.1	75650	1.7	1.2	-1.8	14.5	13.7	14.3	0.48
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.9	51690	3.5	2.8	0.0	14.9	15.7	15.0	0.54
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1084.3	38121	1.5	1.0	-2.9	11.8	12.4	13.3	0.42
*****	JM Large Cap	147.8	422	2.8	1.3	-0.4	12.7	11.8	11.2	0.35
*****	Kotak Large Cap	547.4	10599	1.7	0.7	-2.4	12.0	11.1	12.6	0.35
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.3	53468	1.5	0.8	0.7	11.4	11.3	12.3	0.37
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	500.3	28970	1.4	0.8	-2.8	12.0	11.3	12.2	0.36
***	Bandhan Large Cap	75.2	2007	1.8	0.8	1.1	13.6	12.0	12.9	0.37
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	215.7	2579	1.7	0.7	-0.2	13.6	12.1	12.8	0.39
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	80.6	1439	2.1	0.7	-2.1	11.5	11.2	12.7	0.35
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	974.3	7236	1.5	1.0	-3.0	11.5	9.0	10.8	0.29
***	Invesco India Largecap	67.7	1722	1.8	0.7	0.2	14.6	12.6	12.8	0.39
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	108.1	38239	1.3	0.5	-1.5	10.3	9.8	13.1	0.30
***	Tata Large Cap	494.4	2688	2.0	1.0	0.4	12.4	11.6	12.2	0.37
***	UTI Large Cap	257.2	12053	1.9	1.2	-4.2	9.6	9.0	11.7	0.26
**	DSP Large Cap	451.3	7192	1.5	0.7	-3.6	14.1	11.3	11.8	0.38
**	HSBC Large Cap	456.0	1784	2.1	1.2	-0.6	11.7	10.4	12.2	0.31
**	LIC MF Large Cap	51.7	1352	3.6	2.4	-6.4	8.6	8.2	10.4	0.23
**	Union Largecap	22.6	439	2.1	1.3	-1.7	10.1	9.9	-	0.30
**	Axis Large Cap	57.1	30498	1.6	0.7	-3.7	9.4	7.3	11.9	0.19
**	Groww Largecap	41.5	128	2.7	1.4	0.0	11.4	10.3	11.1	0.30
**	PGIM India Large Cap	321.6	544	2.5	0.9	-3.3	8.2	7.6	10.3	0.22
**	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.6	701	2.0	0.6	-4.9	10.7	9.6	-	0.30
-	Taurus Large Cap	154.4	51	2.1	1.9	1.0	13.0	10.9	10.6	0.33
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	138.2	16672	1.4	0.4	7.3	22.7	18.1	16.3	0.58
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	332.6	28255	1.6	0.8	1.2	17.2	16.5	15.2	0.53
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	994.8	29757	2.0	1.2	1.3	18.4	18.0	16.0	0.65
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.1	15582	2.0	0.9	5.7	16.6	14.3	-	0.40
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	120.7	3249	2.0	0.7	6.1	18.7	16.1	16.1	0.45
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	631.4	38426	1.7	1.0	5.4	15.7	15.3	15.2	0.53
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	180.3	5896	1.9	1.0	3.6	19.7	16.2	14.5	0.55
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	90.3	468	2.1	1.0	6.2	16.3	14.0	13.1	0.42
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	244.2	24675	1.4	0.5	-2.5	13.9	12.5	15.2	0.39
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	603.7	17331	1.4	0.5	-0.6	17.6	13.7	15.3	0.45
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	87.1	4531	1.9	0.5	3.9	16.6	14.2	14.9	0.45
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	99.9	9761	1.5	0.5	6.6	22.7	17.2	16.2	0.48
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	337.5	30251	1.6	0.6	2.5	16.3	14.8	15.6	0.46
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	151.6	42338	1.3	0.5	5.2	15.9	12.7	17.1	0.38
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1458.7	7081	1.8	1.1	2.5	18.8	15.9	13.7	0.50
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	182.9	3399	1.7	1.1	-0.3	14.3	11.8	11.7	0.38
**	PGIM MF Large & Midcap	37.1	2958	3.5	2.3	-2.1	15.7	13.0	14.5	0.40
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	84.5	6575	1.8	0.8	2.9	14.5	13.7	14.5	0.40
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	479.2	7802	1.8	0.7	-6.2	9.2	10.9	12.7	0.34
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	901.6	5648	1.6	0.9	3.1	13.6	9.8	12.0	0.25
**	Navi Large & Midcap	35.1	300	2.1	0.5	1.4	11.4	11.8	12.7	0.34
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.4	4877	3.1	2.0	11.9	20.1	15.8	-	0.40
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1945.7	100479	1.3	0.7	0.3	18.1	17.8	16.6	0.65
*****	JM Flexicap	93.7	5041	2.6	1.4	-2.6	17.7	16.5	16.7	0.49
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.5	140950	1.1	0.5	0.4	15.8	15.0	17.2	0.58
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.7	3320	1.9	0.5	2.7	16.1	13.9	15.0	0.43
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1547.1	19049	1.4	0.8	-4.0	14.9	14.0	13.4	0.44
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.1	5793	1.9	0.6	0.6	10.4	9.6	14.0	0.28
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.4	2294	1.7	0.8	-0.2	12.8	12.2	13.2	0.37
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1838.2	25632	1.4	0.7	5.4	16.9	13.0	14.4	0.40
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	203.9	7285	1.5	0.9	0.7	14.0	11.7	11.1	0.37
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	330.4	13083	1.5	0.5	0.5	12.8	11.5	14.4	0.36
***	DSP Flexi Cap	98.8	11769	1.5	0.6	-2.2	13.8	11.3	14.4	0.33
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	222.0	5405	2.3	1.5	5.5	18.2	14.7	13.4	0.41
***	Kotak Flexicap	83.1	54839	1.4	0.6	0.4	14.1	12.3	14.0	0.38
***	SBI Flexicap	105.1	22403	2.3	1.5	-0.3	10.0	9.8	12.2	0.31
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.4	3633	1.9	0.6	-1.3	13.7	11.1	-	0.35
**	Axis Flexi Cap	26.0	12546	1.7	0.6	0.5	13.1	10.0	-	0.27
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	55.9	12770	1.9	1.1	-5.9	18.2	11.8	12.5	0.32
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.5	260	2.1	0.5	6.7	12.2	11.5	-	0.35
**	UTI Flexi Cap	296.5	22168	1.6	1.0	-6.1	8.1	6.4	11.6	0.14
**	LIC MF Flexi Cap	96.7	973	3.5	2.4	5.2	11.8	10.6	10.6	0.29
**	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	128	3.3	1.7	-1.6	9.1	8.4	-	0.21
**	Taurus Flexi Cap	219.1	344	2.1	2.0	-0.7	12.5	10.7	10.2	0.31
-	Quant Flexi Cap	103.9	6594	2.0	0.8	8.3	18.5	17.1	19.5	0.48
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	285.8	3219	1.7	0.8	4.2	17.1	15.8	14.7	0.44
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	822.3	16997	1.7	0.9	7.1	19.9	16.7	15.4	0.57
-	Invesco India Multicap	132.6	3995	1.6	0.6	-4.1	14.8	12.6	13.6	0.36
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.4	6439	1.6	0.4	7.3	19.5	16.7	-	0.48
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	296.6	52634	1.6	0.9	2.9	19.1	20.3	16.2	0.65
-	Quant Multi Cap	631.5	7466	1.9	0.7	2.3	12.9	12.5	17.3	0.33
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	366.2	2807	2.0	0.9	-0.1	14.9	14.1	14.9	0.43
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	105.5	15911	1.8	0.6	9.0	24.4	20.1	18.9	0.58
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	199.1	94745	1.3	0.7	6.8	22.7	20.3	18.2	0.66
*****	Quant Mid Cap	219.0	7905	2.9	1.8	1.1	18.1	17.0	17.1	0.48
*****	Invesco India Midcap	182.7	11767	1.5	0.5	10.6	25.2	20.3	18.6	0.55
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	35.2	4688	1.6	0.4	9.8	23.8	19.2	-	0.55
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	91.9	35735	1.6	0.8	-6.5	19.4	22.3	16.5	0.58
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4393.3	45820	1.5	0.8	10.4	24.8	21.6	19.1	0.64
***	Axis Midcap	116.2	32276	1.6	0.5	7.1	18.6	15.3	17.1	0.51
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	109.0	2389	1.7	0.5	11.4	21.4	17.4	16.1	0.52
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	337.7	7557	1.8	1.0	19.9	26.7	20.0	17.8	0.60
***	Kotak Midcap	139.2	63539	1.4	0.4	9.5	21.2	18.2	17.9	0.59
***	PGIM India Midcap	63.5	10738	2.0	0.8	2.6	13.0	13.2	15.9	0.34
***	SBI Midcap	234.8	23247	1.6	0.9	1.3	14.6	15.8	14.3	0.49
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1431.6	13378	1.7	0.9	8.1	23.5	19.3	15.3	0.57
***	Tata Mid Cap	445.6	5604	1.9	0.7	8.4	19.8	16.8	16.5	0.51
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	804.0	6290	1.6	0.9	6.1	19.3	16.8	14.1	0.49
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2682.0	12102	1.5	0.9	0.2	19.4	15.4	14.7	0.45
**	Taurus Mid Cap	116.8	123	2.1	1.7	-1.2	13.8	12.4	15.0	0.34
**	UTI Mid Cap	301.1	11680	2.1	1.3	3.9	16.0	14.5	14.4	0.41
**	DSP Midcap	149.9	19459	1.4	0.6	6.2	19.4	13.1	15.2	0.38
**	HSBC Midcap	438.0	13387	3.6	2.5	19.9	27.2	19.2	17.6	0.49
**	LIC MF Midcap	29.2	347	2.4	1.3	2.8	19.3	14.6	-	0.39
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	172.7	72673	1.4	0.7	5.8	20.0	21.2	21.0	0.57
*****	Quant Small Cap	262.1	30374	2.0	1.1	5.5	20.3	20.1	19.1	0.50
*****	AXIS Small Cap	106.5	27364	1.7	0.7	4.3	16.7	16.9	18.3	0.52

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	49.7	2168	1.7	0.5	11.1	21.1	19.2	-	0.48
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	42.4	11038	1.5	0.4	7.5	22.7	20.2	-	0.55
★★★	DSP Small Cap	204.2	17906	1.4	0.6	9.4	19.6	18.2	16.7	0.50
★★★	HDFC Small Cap	133.3	38168	1.5	0.7	0.2	15.1	17.5	17.7	0.49
★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	85.6	8741	1.8	0.8	1.6	14.6	16.5	16.3	0.54
★★★	Kotak Small Cap	255.2	17416	1.7	0.6	1.5	14.3	14.5	16.9	0.40
★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	276.2	3563	1.9	0.9	10.9	20.2	18.1	15.1	0.48
★★★	Tata Small Cap	35.0	11330	1.7	0.4	-9.3	11.6	15.3	-	0.43
★★★	Union Small Cap	53.6	1980	1.8	0.8	17.9	20.4	18.2	16.4	0.46
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	168.7	13850	1.5	0.8	-0.1	17.3	18.5	15.3	0.50
★★	HSBC Small Cap	81.6	16394	1.8	0.7	4.5	16.6	19.0	18.6	0.47
★★	SBI Small Cap	166.7	37141	1.6	0.9	0.2	12.6	13.9	17.8	0.42
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	90.4	5253	1.6	0.8	9.7	17.7	14.2	13.4	0.37
★	LIC MF Small Cap	31.4	660	2.8	1.5	7.1	17.5	17.9	-	0.45
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	38.3	13276	1.5	0.5	2.6	14.7	16.9	-	0.49
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	44.5	5952	2.1	0.8	6.0	18.4	17.8	-	0.52
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
★★★★★	HSBC Value	111.2	14873	1.7	0.7	5.2	20.6	18.0	16.6	0.56
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	458.3	59588	1.6	1.2	-0.1	17.0	17.1	15.4	0.68
★★★★	Bandhan Value	143.3	9907	1.5	0.6	-1.2	13.6	14.8	15.4	0.48
★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	221.0	8919	1.8	1.1	0.5	14.9	16.5	16.2	0.52
★★★★	HDFC Value	741.5	7324	1.8	1.0	3.3	17.5	15.1	14.3	0.48
★★★	JM Value	90.5	826	3.0	1.8	-5.9	16.5	15.6	16.1	0.46
★★★	Templeton India Value	687.2	2150	1.7	0.8	-2.2	13.5	15.6	14.3	0.54
★★★	Union Value	2.7	373	2.1	1.1	1.8	16.2	14.5	-	0.48
★★★	UTI Value	160.6	9433	2.1	1.5	-1.4	15.6	13.1	13.8	0.43
★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	130.6	6388	1.6	0.9	8.1	19.0	15.0	13.0	0.48
★★	Tata Value	339.3	8592	1.8	0.8	0.4	15.5	14.9	15.0	0.48
★	LIC MF Value	26.0	208	3.1	1.8	12.0	16.6	13.6	-	0.37
★	Quantum Value	117.2	1114	2.1	1.1	-5.2	13.3	11.0	11.5	0.39
-	Groww Value	26.4	67	2.8	1.3	0.5	14.9	12.6	10.5	0.39
-	Sundaram Value	207.0	1323	2.2	1.6	-3.2	9.5	10.6	11.2	0.35
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
★★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	135.0	16337	1.4	0.6	-1.7	16.7	14.0	15.6	0.45
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	387.6	12506	1.8	0.8	10.1	17.9	16.0	19.4	0.44
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	425.9	31094	1.6	1.0	-0.4	19.5	17.3	14.9	0.57
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	149.6	6835	1.6	0.6	0.8	15.5	12.8	14.8	0.31
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	160.3	1403	1.8	0.8	1.6	15.9	13.9	16.1	0.48
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	172.9	8529	1.5	0.6	0.9	13.1	11.8	14.8	0.38
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax Saver	1325.0	15559	1.7	1.1	-4.0	16.5	16.8	14.2	0.60
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	47.5	220	2.6	1.3	2.9	16.7	14.6	15.9	0.43
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	48.7	25267	1.4	0.6	3.4	15.2	12.7	17.1	0.39
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	95.4	887	2.0	0.9	3.6	16.9	12.6	12.8	0.38
★★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1376.7	6106	1.6	0.9	-5.5	14.4	13.3	12.6	0.42
★★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	898.5	13911	1.7	1.1	-1.0	13.7	12.4	13.1	0.41
★★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	110.6	6112	1.8	0.7	-2.0	12.5	12.5	14.3	0.38
★★★	Mahindra ELSS Tax Saver	26.7	889	2.0	0.6	-4.6	10.5	11.2	-	0.35
★★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	52.8	4659	2.0	0.8	4.3	22.6	18.2	17.0	0.46
★★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	116.4	209	2.1	0.9	-5.0	13.1	11.0	11.6	0.39
★★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	483.4	1296	2.2	1.6	-2.1	11.9	11.9	13.7	0.39
★★★	Tata ELSS	44.9	4519	1.8	0.8	3.7	14.9	13.3	14.1	0.42
★★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	62.7	841	2.0	1.2	0.4	12.6	12.8	12.8	0.39
★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	111.6	437	2.4	0.8	4.9	14.8	12.8	12.7	0.40
★★	HSBC ELSS Tax Saver	134.0	3939	2.1	1.3	3.1	17.3	13.9	13.8	0.39
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	116.8	2542	1.7	0.8	-4.8	13.3	10.4	13.1	0.29
★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	129.3	14742	1.9	1.2	3.2	16.8	14.6	11.7	0.46
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	32.6	700	2.4	0.9	-4.5	8.8	10.2	12.8	0.32
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	195.0	3438	2.1	1.2	-3.5	11.0	9.8	12.1	0.28
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	59.5	14378	1.5	0.8	2.4	13.6	9.1	10.8	0.26
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	92.2	3156	1.9	1.2	-2.1	11.6	7.9	12.0	0.19
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	140.7	994	2.2	1.0	-6.1	10.8	10.6	12.0	0.33
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.5	50	2.8	1.3	-3.5	10.5	9.7	-	0.27
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.1	46	3.2	1.6	-1.3	8.6	8.4	-	0.21
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	175.2	71	2.1	1.5	-3.3	12.4	11.7	13.1	0.39
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	128.5	19406	1.4	0.5	-1.9	16.8	13.9	15.6	0.43
-	Kotak Contra	147.5	5154	1.9	0.6	2.2	17.7	15.4	16.1	0.49
-	SBI Contra	371.6	47352	1.5	0.7	-1.1	15.7	17.6	16.1	0.66
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	52.4	6458	1.8	0.6	2.6	19.7	19.5	16.3	0.73
★★★★	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	136.1	2306	1.7	1.1	-1.7	14.7	15.3	15.5	0.60
★★★★	LIC MF Dividend Yield	31.0	661	2.5	1.1	2.8	20.5	16.0	-	0.47
★★★★	UTI Dividend Yield	173.3	3750	2.4	1.9	1.1	17.2	14.1	14.5	0.48
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	482.8	1475	1.8	1.1	4.4	17.1	16.0	13.6	0.53
★	Sundaram Dividend Yield	130.7	856	2.3	1.1	-1.8	13.3	12.1	14.9	0.42
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	181.9	2443	2.0	0.7	-6.6	12.0	14.3	12.9	0.45
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	29.1	1419	1.8	0.6	-5.0	11.6	11.7	-	0.35
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumption	102.5	1901	1.8	0.7	-4.2	12.1	12.5	15.4	0.36
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	198.7	5996	1.6	0.7	-5.4	10.9	11.6	13.9	0.35
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	87.2	4455	1.6	0.4	-2.1	12.1	13.3	15.4	0.38
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	280.8	2933	2.5	1.5	-8.1	9.4	13.6	14.1	0.43
★★★★	Tata India Consumer	44.0	2591	2.0	0.8	3.4	16.0	14.8	16.2	0.42
★★★	Sundaram Consumption	88.1	1428	2.1	1.3	-7.4	11.7	11.8	11.9	0.36
★★	UTI India Consumer	54.4	674	2.5	1.7	-2.1	11.4	11.0	11.3	0.30
★	Mahindra Manu Consumption	21.0	504	2.1	0.6	-4.0	11.1	11.1	-	0.33
-	ICICI Pru FMCG	423.0	1676	2.5	1.7	-10.8	0.8	8.5	10.3	0.26
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Opport	103.3	1613	2.1	0.8	0.8	14.2	13.3	14.7	0.40
★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	141.7	1673	1.8	0.7	7.1	18.3	14.5	15.8	0.41
★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	621.7	7470	2.0	1.2	1.3	13.9	14.3	14.3	0.44
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	60.2	3541	1.7	0.9	1.4	12.4	11.4	13.2	0.32
★★★★	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	127.2	10589	2.2	1.4	-3.0	10.8	10.2	13.7	0.32
★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	42.5	10375	2.0	1.1	4.5	16.7	12.7	15.9	0.33
★★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	42.2	3043	1.9	0.6	1.0	13.2	11.7	14.8	0.36
★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	46.7	389	2.1	0.7	-0.2	13.4	11.1	12.3	0.30
★★	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	186.6	1350	4.4	3.4	1.0	12.7	11.4	11.6	0.32
★	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	20.5	262	2.4	1.2	1.0	8.1	9.6	9.9	0.27
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	51.9	11	2.1	1.4	-2.3	9.2	10.0	13.0	0.28
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
★★★★★	SBI Technology Opport	185.9	4240	1.9	0.9	-11.3	9.4	10.5	15.1	0.27
★★★★	ICICI Pru Technology	165.9	13068	2.1	1.4	-13.0	8.3	8.3	15.2	0.21
★★★★	Franklin Ind Technology	448.7	1648	1.8	1.0	-9.6	14.0	10.2	14.6	0.24
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	144.6	3799	1.6	0.8	-12.8	6.1	7.4	14.9	0.18
★	Tata Digital India	38.9	9697	1.7	0.6	-16.1	6.6	7.7	14.4	0.18
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru P.H.D	41.8	6669	2.4	1.6	9.5	29.0	16.1	-	0.56
★★★★	DSP Healthcare	40.8	3147	1.7	0.5	9.4	23.2	14.2	-	0.43
★★★	Mirae Asset Healthcare	42.3	3939	1.7	0.5	14.9	26.9	14.7	-	0.47
★★★	Nippon Ind Pharma	540.9	8365	2.3	1.5	8.3	24.5	13.2	15.2	0.43
★★★	SBI Healthcare Opport	466.3	4323	1.9	0.9	11.3	26.7	15.8	13.2	0.54
★★	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	31.6	1325	2.2	0.7	7.0	24.3	13.8	13.0	0.44
★	UTI Healthcare	308.8	1144	2.3	1.4	12.2	27.7	14.1	13.5	0.45
-	LIC MF Healthcare	31.1	85	2.4	1.1	10.8	24.6	11.1	-	0.32
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
★★★★★	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	40.4	1482	1.8	0.7	8.7	20.1	16.8	-	0.48
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	396.5	50368	1.5	1.0	3.1	16.7	16.9	15.8	0.79
★★★★★	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	451.0	2024	2.1	0.8	9.9	14.7	13.7	15.7	0.47
★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Aggressive Hybrid	27.5	1239	1.9	0.5	0.4	12.5	10.5	-	0.39
★★★★	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	63.3	3627	1.9	0.5	1.9	14.6	13.6	12.7	0.57
★★★★	JM Aggressive Hybrid	113.9	701	2.9	1.4	-2.5	15.5	13.1	12.1	0.46
★★★★	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	62.9	8642	1.8	0.5	4.8	13.8	12.3	13.1	0.47
★★★★	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	39.7	6524	1.9	1.2	-0.5	13.5	12.6	12.2	0.53
★★★	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	26.6	1919	1.8	0.5	7.1	14.4	12.3	-	0.44
★★★	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	356.5	11024	1.5	0.5	1.2	11.7	10.4	12.5	0.39
★★★	DSP Aggressive Hybrid	342.4	11852	1.5	0.6	-3.7	12.4	10.2	12.2	0.39

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %p.a	3 Month %p.a	6 Month %p.a	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2116.2	1048	0.4	0.2	4.6	6.3	6.0	5.9	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	443.6	56604	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Axis Liquid	3067.4	51643	0.2	0.1	5.2	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3323.7	17385	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3172.4	1735	0.1	0.1	5.2	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3164.5	11412	0.2	0.1	5.2	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3315.3	6395	0.1	0.1	5.3	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
- DSP Liquidity	3931.1	22480	0.2	0.1	4.9	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3522.8	15091	0.2	0.1	5.3	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- Groww Liquid	2662.8	278	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.6	6.2	6.1	-
- HDFC Liquid	5401.5	72873	0.3	0.2	5.0	6.5	6.3	6.1	-
- HSBC Liquid	2744.4	17559	0.2	0.1	5.0	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	407.4	54639	0.3	0.2	5.1	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3784.2	16549	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- ITI Liquid	1432.3	55	0.2	0.2	5.2	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	75.1	2835	0.3	0.2	5.2	6.3	6.1	6.0	-
- Kotak Liquid	5562.3	42389	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- LIC MF Liquid	4976.7	15638	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1791.6	1059	0.2	0.1	5.0	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2885.4	13590	0.2	0.1	4.8	6.4	6.1	6.1	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	974	0.4	0.2	4.4	5.8	5.7	5.7	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.0	974	-	0.2	4.7	6.0	5.9	5.9	-
- Navi Liquid	29.8	76	0.2	0.2	4.7	5.6	5.6	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6717.4	37903	0.3	0.2	4.9	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1526.7	5260	0.2	0.1	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.0	-
- PGIM India Liquid	358.4	584	0.2	0.1	5.2	6.6	6.2	6.1	4.30
- Quant Liquid	43.4	1266	0.6	0.3	4.1	5.3	5.6	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	36.7	529	0.3	0.2	4.6	5.6	5.6	5.6	-
- SBI Liquid	4301.8	74571	0.3	0.2	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2425.8	7086	0.4	0.1	5.0	6.4	6.1	6.0	-
- Tata Liquid	4336.7	27400	0.3	0.2	5.1	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
- Union Liquid	2650.0	8163	0.2	0.1	5.3	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
- UTI Liquid	4518.4	31184	0.3	0.2	5.2	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1479.0	568	0.3	0.2	4.6	6.3	6.1	6.0	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1454.6	6108	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1430.9	11376	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1435.4	632	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1376.2	43	0.1	0.1	7.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1418.6	867	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1399.0	296	0.7	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1444.6	2116	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1398.2	208	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1410.5	949	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1388.6	83	0.3	0.2	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- HDFC Overnight	3979.5	9431	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1407.7	4223	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1452.8	11369	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1365.7	337	0.1	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1363.6	16	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.1	-
- JM Overnight	1368.7	89	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.9	4.9	5.2	-
- Kotak Overnight	1437.8	7487	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1394.8	530	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1394.7	128	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1383.0	1389	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	144.7	6199	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1392.3	44	0.2	0.2	4.9	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4351.5	27043	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1430.8	624	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1420.7	4376	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- Union Overnight	1418.2	411	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- UTI Overnight	3672.5	5730	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.9	25679	0.9	0.3	1.9	4.6	5.3	5.7	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9718	2.5	1.8	2.1	4.8	5.4	5.7	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.0	7895	0.9	0.3	2.0	4.6	5.1	5.5	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.5	45	0.9	0.4	3.3	4.7	5.2	5.5	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1255	0.9	0.3	2.1	4.6	5.0	5.5	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.7	6512	0.9	0.3	1.7	4.5	5.2	5.6	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.4	14717	3.3	2.7	2.2	4.9	5.4	5.8	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.2	24439	0.8	0.4	2.3	4.8	5.5	5.8	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2532	2.3	1.7	1.8	5.1	5.5	5.8	-
- ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.0	32299	2.2	1.7	2.2	4.8	5.5	5.8	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.6	27321	0.9	0.3	3.1	4.9	5.5	5.9	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.6	88	0.9	0.3	3.5	5.3	5.7	6.0	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.2	367	1.5	0.8	3.5	4.7	5.3	5.5	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.4	69951	1.0	0.4	2.8	5.0	5.5	5.8	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	244	0.9	0.3	2.7	5.0	5.5	5.6	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	112	1.0	0.3	2.1	4.2	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	17.3	3461	0.8	0.1	3.0	4.6	5.3	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.9	16332	2.8	2.1	2.5	4.8	5.4	5.7	0.80
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.2	97	1.0	0.4	3.8	5.1	5.5	5.3	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.6	42847	2.3	1.8	3.2	5.1	5.6	5.9	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.2	442	1.0	0.3	4.0	5.1	5.7	5.7	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.1	21824	1.1	0.3	2.2	4.8	5.6	5.8	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.7	239	0.9	0.3	2.9	4.9	5.3	5.5	-
- UTI Arbitrage	36.8	10858	2.4	1.8	2.1	4.7	5.4	5.9	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	577.2	19985	0.5	0.3	6.0	7.0	7.1	6.3	10.83
***** Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1623.2	651	0.4	0.3	6.0	6.8	7.0	6.2	-
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4234.6	11083	1.1	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	6.7	18.83
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	4458	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.8	6.0	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.1	15929	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.9	6.1	8.82
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1376.9	1420	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.9	7.0	6.2	1.41
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4446.2	4126	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.4	6.6	6.3	7.74
***** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	5916	1.2	0.4	5.4	6.3	6.4	5.6	8.36
***** DSP Ultra Short	3569.2	4167	0.9	0.3	5.4	6.4	6.5	5.6	7.24
***** HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16753	0.7	0.4	5.6	6.6	6.8	5.9	4.41
***** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1424.4	3118	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
***** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2832.7	1073	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.7	5.8	9.14
***** Kotak Savings	45.0	16824	0.8	0.4	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	6.77
***** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1445.9	212	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.8	5.9	3.55
***** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6278.6	12553	0.6	0.4	5.8	6.7	6.8	6.0	8.65
***** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1425.4	580	1.1	0.6	5.3	6.2	6.3	5.5	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3315.8	154	0.9	0.4	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.5	7.16
*** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1384.0	342	1.4	0.2	5.4	6.2	6.3	5.5	1.58
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	167	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.1	6.3	5.6	3.01
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	5713	1.2	0.3	5.6	6.4	6.5	5.6	8.37
*** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3982.0	498	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.4	-
*** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	428	1.2	0.2	4.9	5.5	5.6	4.8	-
*** Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2799.4	1817	1.4	0.2	4.8	5.7	5.9	5.1	1.71

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	571.8	27700	0.6	0.4	5.7	7.1	7.3	6.4	6.63
***** UTI Low Duration	3727.2	3108	0.4	0.3	5.6	7.0	7.0	7.2	7.09
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3247.6	6084	0.7	0.4	5.5	6.9	6.9	6.1	7.38

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	DSP Low Duration	20.7	5108	0.5	0.3	5.1	6.5	6.6	5.8	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	60.4	21926	1.1	0.5	5.2	6.6	6.7	5.9	12.68
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	1058	0.9	0.4	5.4	7.3	7.3	6.1	9.66
***	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	685.3	13267	1.0	0.4	4.9	6.3	6.4	5.7	10.00
***	Bandhan Low Duration	40.4	6121	0.6	0.3	5.2	6.6	6.7	5.8	-
***	Canara Robeco Savings	44.2	1140	0.4	0.2	5.4	6.6	6.8	5.8	-
***	Invesco India Low Duration	3964.5	1690	0.5	0.3	5.3	6.7	6.8	5.8	6.04
***	JM Low Duration	38.8	223	0.9	0.4	5.2	6.6	6.6	5.7	5.59
***	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3920.5	9417	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.9	7.52
***	SBI Low Duration	3649.4	13458	0.9	0.4	5.0	6.4	6.5	5.7	3.92
***	Tata Treasury Advantage	4118.7	2859	0.6	0.3	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.9	3.99
***	Kotak Low Duration	3494.2	16259	1.2	0.4	5.0	6.5	6.5	5.7	11.10
***	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1709.4	561	0.9	0.3	5.1	6.4	6.5	5.6	13.58
***	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2361.3	2314	0.7	0.2	5.1	6.5	6.6	5.7	4.97
***	Sundaram Low Duration	3607.6	369	1.1	0.4	4.7	6.3	6.4	5.6	3.53
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.9	292	0.9	0.2	5.0	6.3	6.4	5.5	1.72
***	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1692	0.5	0.3	5.1	6.4	6.4	5.6	3.12

Regional VAT gap widens fuel divide, AP sees highest prices, Gujarat cheapest

RATE JUMP. Petrol sells above ₹112 a litre after the latest revisions in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Kerala

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The pump price of petrol is highest in Andhra Pradesh, while it is lowest in Gujarat, a comparison of fuel prices in 20 States and Union Territory showed. A government source claimed that even after three rounds of revision, price hike of petrol and diesel is lowest in the world.

According to data compiled by government officials, in three States petrol is above ₹112 a litre after the latest revision: Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Kerala. “These three States levy the highest VAT (Value Added Tax) rates in the country,” said a source adding that Andhra Pradesh charges 31 per cent VAT along with ₹4 a litre plus a road development cess, taking the effective rate close to 35 per cent. Petrol is costliest at ₹117.80/litre

In Telangana, petrol is close to ₹116/litre. Kerala adds a social security cess on top of its base VAT. Six States have petrol at or below ₹102 a

State-wise price of petrol (As on May 23, ₹/litre)			
State	Price	State	Price
Andhra Pradesh	117.8	Tamil Nadu	105.6
Telangana	115.7	Chhattisgarh	105.2
Kerala	112.3	Jharkhand	102.6
Madhya Pradesh	111.4	Assam	101.9
Bihar	110.4	Goa	101.3
West Bengal	109.8	Punjab	101.1
Rajasthan	109.5	Haryana	99.7
Maharashtra	108.5	Delhi	99.5
Karnataka	107.7	Uttar Pradesh	99.5
Odisha	105.9	Gujarat	99.1

litre: Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Delhi, Haryana, Goa and Assam.

“All six are governed by the BJP. The same opposition leaderships that ask the Centre to cut the excise duty for the relief of the consumer have at no point cut the VAT their own State governments levy on the same litre of fuel,” another source said.

According to him, when the central excise duty was cut on March 27 by ₹10 a litre on petrol and diesel, the BJP-ruled States passed the full

cut through to the pump. The Congress-ruled and INDIA-bloc States did not separately reduce VAT, which means the consumer in those States still pays more than the consumer in a BJP-ruled State directly because of State taxation.

SURGING CRUDE

“The framing that the Central government over-taxes fuel collapses against the State-level data. The States that tax fuel most are the political opponents of the Centre,”

he said.

Between the Russia-Ukraine war that began in February 2022 and the Hormuz disruption that began in February 2026, the international price of crude oil has been through two of the sharpest disturbances since the 1970s. Brent has crossed \$120/barrel twice in that window. Every major importing economy in the world has passed on the cost to its consumers, in some cases several times over. India has done the opposite.

“Across the same four years the India has cut the retail price of petrol and diesel four times, the last of those cuts coming on the eve of the Hormuz disruption itself,” the first source said. According to him, India is the only major economy to have cut retail fuel prices through the Russia-Ukraine window. “The cumulative OMC revision of just under ₹5 a litre across May 15, 19 and 23 is the smallest material upward movement of any major economy outside the directly subsidising Gulf producers,” he said.

Hyderabad police’s AI app CopWriter can record complaints in 10 languages



FIRST OF ITS KIND. Hyderabad Police Commissioner V C Sajjanar launching an AI-CopWriter in Hyderabad on Saturday

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

The Hyderabad City Police on Saturday launched AI-CopWriter, a first-of-its-kind AI-powered mobile app that allows officers to record, transcribe, and translate complaints in 10 major Indian languages in real time at every police station.

MODERN POLICING

Any citizen can now lodge a complaint in their mother tongue. The app transcribes and translates spoken words into a complete, accurate FIR within seconds — removing the language barrier and making police services more accessible to all, including migrants and non-Telugu speakers.

The Hyderabad City Police is leveraging artificial intelligence to enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of modern policing. The Department is already utilising

AI through the ‘C-Mitra’ platform for drafting cyber-crime complaints.

POSTING BY AI

An AI-powered system has been launched for duty allocation of City Armed Reserve (CAR) personnel. By transitioning from traditional manual methods, the Department has ensured a transparent and unbiased process of assigning postings to employees. It has also deployed AI in its Social Media Surveillance platform called SO-CEYE to monitor online content, track habitual cyber troublemakers, and identify narratives that threaten public order or women’s safety.

In its latest initiative, the Hyderabad City Police has integrated AI for the streamlined registration of complaints, marking a significant step toward smarter and more efficient public service.

New US rule mandates Green Card seekers to apply from their home country

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The pathway to Green Card for immigrants in the US, including those on H-1B or L-1 visas, just got a bit more complicated as the US immigration authorities brought out a new policy note.

Migrants to the US seeking permanent residency or a Green Card will have to return to their home country to file their applications, per a new US Citizenship and Immigration Service (USCIS) policy note on Friday.

“From now on, an alien who is in the US temporarily and wants a Green Card must return to their home country to apply, except in extraordinary circumstances,” USCIS spokesman Zach Kahler said in a statement here.

“Non-immigrants, like students, temporary workers, or people on tourist visas, come to the US for a short time and for a specific purpose. Our system is designed for them to leave when their visit is over. Their visit should not function as the first step in the Green Card process,” the statement said.

SOME EXCEPTIONS

USCIS noted that this was meant for the US to “return to the original intent of the law” and will also



POLICY RESTORATION. USCIS said this was meant for the US to “return to the original intent of the law” and will also ensure that it frees up limited USCIS resources

ensure that it frees up limited USCIS resources in the US. However, subsequently, in a clarification statement, USCIS spokesman Kahler suggested that Green Card applicants in the US who provide an “economic benefit” or serve “national interest” will be allowed to complete their processing here, without having to leave.

The policy has set off widespread confusion and apprehensions among H-1B and L1 work visa holders in the US, many of whom are Indians and also in the STEM field. They may now have to rely on visa appointments in their home country consulates and this can lead to a disruption from their personal and professional lives for an indefinite period of time, they fear.

For H-1B and L-1 employees whose visas are “dual intent” the memo suggests they can now expect detailed reviews and

not automatic approvals for Green Cards like earlier.

On a case-to-case basis, they may be asked to process it in home countries. Non-dual-intent categories such as student categories including F-1 OPT/STEM OPT, etc., will also face heightened scrutiny of intent and prior conduct, immigration attorneys said.

Immigration law firm Reddy Neumann Brown in a note said, “The message is clear: Meeting the eligibility requirements alone may no longer be enough. From tax compliance and lawful status history to community ties, family integration, and economic contributions, applicants should now be prepared to proactively document the positive equities supporting their I-485 case,” it said.

NEW STANDARD

Immigration lawyer Poorvi Chothani of

LawQuest said that what has changed is the standard of review, not the law. “The memorandum does not change any laws or regulations and does not eliminate adjustment of status (AOS) as a legal avenue to apply for a Green Card. Section 245 of the Immigration and Nationality Act continues to authorise AOS in the US for eligible applicants at USCIS’ discretion,” she said, noting that legal challenges are widely expected.

Andrew NG, co-founder of Coursera and a top AI entrepreneur in the US, said in a post on X that “The new White House policy requiring Green Card applicants to apply from outside the US is a capricious attack on legal immigration. It will hurt families, leave us with fewer doctors, teachers and scientists, and hurt American competitiveness in AI.”

H-1B APPLICANTS DIP

Separately, releasing its FY27 numbers for H-1B registrations, the USCIS said that the number dipped by 38.5 per cent, from 343,981 in fiscal year 2026 to just 211,600 in fiscal year 2027. “We’re approving more applicants with advanced degrees and higher salaries especially those who studied at US universities,” it added.

SPIC Q4 net up despite sales dip; cost control helps

Our Bureau
Chennai

Southern Petrochemical Industries Corporation Ltd reported a consolidated net profit of ₹29.5 crore for the quarter ended March 2026 (Q4FY26) as against ₹19.5 crore in the same quarter last year. The profit grew despite a decline in revenue from operations, which came in at ₹584 crore compared to ₹754 crore in Q4FY25.

For the full year FY26, the net profit was ₹211.6 crore compared to ₹155.6 crore. Revenue was ₹2,956 crore versus ₹3,086 crore.

“Even though sales were lower than the corresponding period last year, and despite a little over 2 weeks of plant shutdown for scheduled maintenance, we delivered a significant increase in profit through efficient cost control and prudent raw-material sourcing,” Ashwin Muthiah, Chairman, said in a statement.

During the quarter, the production and sale of urea were 1.48 lakh million tonnes and 1.43 lakh mt, respectively.

Goyal to meet Canadian PM Carney to fast-track free trade negotiations

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In a significant push to fast-track bilateral free trade negotiations, Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney and Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu are set to hold high-level talks with Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal during his official visit to Canada on May 25-27.

Meetings are also planned with major Canadian businesses and institutional investors, including the ‘Maple Eight’ pension funds, in a bid to channel long-term investments into India, Goyal said in an interaction with the media on Saturday.

On the weakening rupee, Goyal said the government does not interfere in exchange rates as these are determined by market forces and influenced by several global factors. However, the government is always conscious of taking steps to promote exports, reduce import dependence and promote a



Canada's Prime Minister Mark Carney REUTERS

greater degree of investment into India, he added.

\$50-BILLION TRADE

Goyal, leading a 150-member Indian business delegation to Canada, noted that both nations aim to reach \$50 billion in bilateral trade within five years while boosting Canadian investments.

“Both sides have been preparing so well for the FTA that Canadian PM Mark Carney is himself meeting me together with my counterpart Maninder Sidhu. So I am spending three days in Ottawa and Toronto where I

have a number of business engagements and roundtables with big investors and businesses,” Goyal said.

INVESTMENT TALKS

“Canada has already invested over \$100 billion in India and we want to increase investment flows,” he said.

About 600 Canadian companies operate in India, and both sides are aiming to raise that number to 1,000, Goyal said.

The India-Canada FTA, officially called the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, has been progressing with speed since the signing of the terms of reference during Carney’s India visit in March. The first round of negotiations was conducted virtually in March and the second round concluded on May 8, 2026. The third negotiating round will take place in Ottawa from May 25-29 during Goyal’s visit, a Commerce Department statement noted.

Minda Q4 net jumps 138% on premiumisation push

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Minda Corporation reported its strongest-ever quarterly and annual performance in FY26, helped by rising electronics content in vehicles, premiumisation trends and strong demand across two-wheelers and commercial vehicles.

Revenue from operations rose 29 per cent year-on-year to ₹1,704 crore in Q4FY26 from ₹1,321 crore a year earlier. EBITDA increased 33 per cent to ₹203 crore from ₹153 crore, while the net profit surged 138 per cent to ₹124 crore from ₹52 crore.

For FY26, revenue from operations rose 22 per cent to ₹6,185 crore from ₹5,056 crore in FY25. EBITDA increased 25 per cent to ₹721 crore from ₹575 crore, while the net profit climbed 40 per cent to ₹358 crore from ₹255 crore.

The company said FY26 marked its highest-ever consolidated revenue and operating profit performance. Chairman and Group CEO Ashok Minda said growth was supported by demand across two-wheelers and commercial vehicles, policy support and continued investments in R&D and technology partnerships.

FUTURE FOCUS

“Our focus remains on operational efficiency, customer relationships, and disciplined financial management, as we work towards sustaining

growth and creating long-term value for all stakeholders,” he said.

The company is increasingly repositioning itself from a traditional auto-component maker into a smart mobility and EV systems player. Its FY27-FY30 strategy is centred on EV power electronics, connected vehicle systems, telematics, on-board chargers and EV drivetrain technologies as vehicles become more software/electronic-intensive.

CONNECTED BUSINESS

Minda said the company is “transforming from mechatronics to advance technology provider,” with greater focus on embedded software, electrical architecture and advanced automotive electronics. Its Information and Connected Systems business, which includes wiring harnesses and instrument clusters, grew 29 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,342 crore in FY26 from ₹2,581 crore in FY25, aided by premiumisation and demand growth in two-wheelers and commercial vehicles.

During FY26, Minda partnered Japan’s Toyodenso for advanced automotive switches and UK-based Turntide Technologies for EV powertrain solutions, strengthening its access to higher-value electronics and electrification technologies.

The company’s balance sheet also improved, with net debt-to-EBITDA reducing to 1.2x from 1.8x in FY25, while return on capital employed rose to 23 per cent.

Rajnath Singh flags off first set of India-made Suryastra rocket launchers for the Army

Dalip Singh
Shirdi (Maharashtra)

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Saturday flagged off the first batch of Suryastra Universal Rocket Launchers from Nibe Ltd’s upcoming facility in Shirdi for induction into the Indian Army, marking partial fulfilment of a ₹293-crore emergency procurement order awarded to the company in January to strengthen the country’s precision firepower capabilities.

MAJOR MILESTONES

Speaking at the flagging off function, Singh listed the milestones of the programme. The first is the inauguration of a modern factory for manufacturing artillery shells; it will have an annual capacity to produce 5 lakh shells. The second is the laying of the foundation stone for a missile complex associated with the Universal Rocket Launching System. The third is signing a contract with US company Black Sky that will take “our

private industry to great heights,” he said.

“...the country which manufactures its own weapons is the one that writes its own destiny. The situation today is that foreign companies also want to join us, want to do technology transfer with us,” the Minister told a large gathering.

He also stated that private participation in defence has gone up to 25-30 per cent and he expects it to climb to 50 per cent in times to come.

Nibe Group’s ₹3,000-crore defence manufacturing complex was also inaugurated. Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis, Chief of Defence Staff Gen Anil Chauhan, DRDO Chairman Samir V Kamat, and Nibe Group CMD Ganesh Nibe were present at the event.

ISRAELI TECH

Developed using technology from Israel’s Elbit Systems and in-house R&D, the Suryastra system successfully underwent firing trials on May 18 and 19 at the Integrated Test Range. According to the company, the system fea-



Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis welcomes Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh at Shirdi airport on Saturday. ANI

tures “shoot-and-scoot” capabilities and can fire multiple types of munitions, including precision-guided rockets in the 150-km to 300-km class, as well as loitering munitions with ranges of up to 100 km.

The company’s Chief Technical Officer, Balakrishnan Swamy, said projections indicate that the Army could eventually require seven-nine regiments of the Suryastra Universal Rocket Launcher system, potentially valued at around ₹6,000 crore.

Swamy said the rollout marks the beginning of a ma-

jor expansion in Nibe Group’s defence manufacturing operations. The company plans to invest ₹10,000 crore over time, boost local supply chain and generate around 5,000 jobs.

DRONE DEVELOPMENT

Swamy said the company is also developing an indigenous drone with a range of 1,000 km, which is expected to be ready for demonstration within six months. The project is believed to draw lessons from the battlefield success of Iran’s Shahed kamikaze drones in conflicts involving the US and Israel.

Ministry of Consumer Affairs told to probe policies of online ticket platforms on cancellation charges

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Minister of Consumer Affairs Pralhad Joshi on Saturday directed the Consumer Affairs Ministry and the Central Consumer Protection Authority to investigate the cancellation charges practices followed by online ticketing platforms.

In a social media post on X, Joshi said, “I have directed the Department of Consumer Affairs and CCPA to investigate whether online ticket booking platforms are imposing excessive cancellation charges on consumers, beyond what is charged by airlines or disclosed at the time of booking.”

“Such practices undermine transparency and consumer trust and, if found to be unfair or in violation of consumer rights, may amount to unfair trade practices under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. CCPA will take necessary action, including class action measures wherever appropriate, to protect consumer interests and ensure fair treatment of consumers,” he added.

This direction came after Tajinder Bagga, National Secretary of the Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM), in a social media post, alleged there was a



sharp difference in the cancellation charges of tickets booked directly with an airline and through an online travel platform. In his post he made an allegation against Agoda for charging higher cancellation charge than what is directly charged by Akasa Air.

Joshi in his post said the investigation will look into all cancellation charges being levied by all online ticketing platforms.

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